

DESTINY'S THRESHOLD

THRESHOLD PURSUIT

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Writer's
Pocke

First published by Writer's Pocket in 2024

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cover design by Rabason

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ISBN-13: 978-93-6083-720-4

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DEDICATION

- To, friends and the people who dream of writing a book.
- Restless Nights
- Education system of India (promoting me to realize how much of a misfit I am)
- Memories of People Came and Gone
- Finally, to parents who taught me how to dream and woke me up when I overslept. But always supported even my wildest of endeavours.

*This book shall forever mark the existence of
people gone, started as a practical Joke this
book holds a weird but exciting tale of
imagination but what it offers is a way to
reignite the flames of Life for those who lost
them.*

1. The Tower's Edge

(Jerry's POV)

As I stood atop the metallic tower, the overcast sky mirrored the heaviness in my heart. It seemed that only a select few possessed the power to truly change the world, while the rest of us remained nameless and powerless, striving for a mere semblance of peace before our inevitable demise. Most people seemed content with the way things were, but there were a few who yearned for something more, and even fewer who strived for the greater good. However, the foundation of capitalism, deeply embedded in the evolution of humanity, had set us on a path where the rotting core of greed prevented us from progressing far.

I had no intentions of witnessing the consequences of this decay; I wouldn't be around to see it unfold. In my belief, the concept of victory was the harbinger of doom for our world. Victory could not exist without defeat, and with defeat came restless souls. These restless souls became obsessed with the pursuit of victory, leading them astray from the path of humanity and the principles we, as humans, had collectively decided upon as laws. Whenever I encountered the concept of victory, I found myself looking for the failures instead. The victors were always celebrated and comforted, but it was the losers who truly needed support. Yet, I couldn't expect society to hold loser parades or acknowledge their struggle. It had become commonplace for us to associate victory with a sense of pride.

Perhaps it was this distorted understanding of victory that led humanity to invent destructive weapons like nuclear bombs. These weapons offered the immediate satisfaction of victory over Japan, a temptation that American leaders couldn't resist. The allure of victory was and will always be strong, deeply ingrained in our nature. However, we cannot blame God for the mess we have created in this world. Humans mostly associated losing with bad luck, but I would argue that true defeat only occurs when the person never had a chance to win. Otherwise, it is nothing but a humiliating blow dealt by the opposition.

I found myself typing these thoughts on a famous micro-blogging site, fully aware that they were neither good news nor particularly relevant. However, I wanted this message to reach everyone, hoping that someone out there might change their perspective. I didn't seek gratitude for it; all I desired was to contribute to making this world a better place. As I typed, I reminisced about my eventful life thus far. I had been fortunate to have good friends and to be the fun-loving type. However, recent experiences had opened my eyes to unpleasant truths, prompting me to sever contact with everyone except one person—Charlie (Charles).

Charlie was quite the opposite of what people perceived him to be. Although most would find it laughable if they heard me describe him as a nice guy, he always carried an invincible attitude. It seemed like he had no weaknesses, except perhaps for the scorching sun. Life had treated him well, and he was a perfect example of a winner. Maybe that's why we were such close friends—opposites attract.

“Enough of this sentimental thinking,” I told myself aloud, trying to gather my resolve. I had come to this tower with the intention of ending my life, and that was precisely what I would do. Shouting out, I reassured myself that I wasn’t the kind of person who acted impulsively or avoided overthinking. I should have jumped from this tower hours ago, but I had been preoccupied with thoughts of that micro-blog. Strangely enough, I was scared of dying alone, even though loneliness wasn’t the reason for my suicidal thoughts.

The catalyst for my despair had been my attempt to propose to the love of my life, only to be met with a barrage of slander from her and her friends in my class. They maliciously attacked my character in front of their boyfriends and besties, blurring the line between the two. Although using the term “love of my life” at my age might sound cringy, I genuinely believed that if I could be with her, I wouldn’t let her go. It was a childish belief, but we all needed something to hold onto in order to keep living. These fabricated beliefs had sustained me for the past two years, but they weren’t perfect or powerful enough to shield me from the overwhelming temptation of self-sacrifice. I believed that ending my life would bring peace of mind to my family, who suffered every day because of my failures. They made it abundantly clear through their expressions and words that they no longer wanted me around, considering me a burden—a depreciating asset.

They say that your life flashes before your eyes in your final moments, that you see the balance of good and bad deeds. I wondered what I would see. Would the images be more painful, or would they bring me peace in my last moments on this plane of existence? It took immense

courage to stand here now. Although reaching the top of this tower had been my own choice, my brain wasn't quite ready to die. Our natural instinct is to cling to life, but I had reached my breaking point. I refused to be a coward, as I had been throughout my entire existence.

With determined steps, I moved closer to the edge of the red metallic beam at the top of the cell tower. Peering down, I saw the overcast sky enveloping the entire city. In that moment, I felt a flicker of happiness for Charlie, who always found joy in the rain, regardless of the circumstances. As the thought of his contentment brought me a moment of peace, I silenced the swirling thoughts in my mind. "Stop thinking, Jerry," I commanded myself, and without further hesitation, I leaped into the void.

As I hurtled toward the ground, a scream escaped my lips, blending with the rushing wind. The acceleration of 9.8 m/s^2 only amplified the sense of impending doom. The end was clear to me—it wasn't a vision of white light or encounters with divine beings. I knew I was dead because, after I "opened my eyes" or whatever sensation I could perceive in this unfamiliar state, all I sensed was darkness. There was no shock, for I had anticipated this outcome. I had expected to be trapped forever in the fields of asphodel, unable to feel control or escape the torment of existence. That was the very essence of my decision to end my life—to cease feeling anything at all.

Ironically, it seemed that God hadn't finished toying with me yet. Instead of granting me the blissful release of an unconscious void, He allowed me to retain my consciousness, leaving me to suffer within my thoughts. This punishment was far worse than anything the fields of punishment could offer. Yet, deep down, I understood

that it was the right punishment for me. I had willingly embraced it. Time became a distorted concept, difficult to measure or comprehend, as the white void engulfed the plane of existence I found myself in. It was blinding—pure and all-encompassing.

2. Bound By Will

As I emerged from the blinding white light, my senses were immediately overwhelmed by the sheer magnitude of the space around me. It stretched out as far as my eyes could see, an expansive expanse of white that seemed endless in every direction. But then, something incredible happened—the space began to rotate, like a massive graviton coming to life.

At first, the rotation was slow, and I didn't pay it much attention, my mind already clouded by the strangeness of the situation. However, I soon regretted my indifference, for as soon as I stood up, the graviton activated with tremendous force, hurling me toward the edge of the rotating circle at an alarming speed. It was as if the centrifugal and centripetal forces were locked in a delicate equilibrium, keeping me pinned to that spot, even though there appeared to be no physical boundary.

With this revelation in mind, I resisted the urge to get up and move closer to the center, knowing that the centrifugal force would only intensify, pushing me back to where I started. "So this is supposed to be my hell," I yelled in frustration, hoping that someone, somewhere, could hear me. But in that moment, as soon as the word "hell" left my lips, the rotation abruptly ceased, and a sudden calm settled over the space.

I stood up, trying to make sense of my surroundings. Perhaps I was lying in a hospital bed, near the end of my life, and the anesthesia hadn't taken effect. That would be the only logical explanation for the bizarre experience I

was going through. "So much for healthcare," I shouted, half-jokingly, hoping that the doctors could still hear me. But before I could dwell on my unfortunate fate, the arena began to shake violently, as if an earthquake were rocking the very foundation of the white expanse.

Instinctively, I scrambled to find something to hold onto, searching for an edge or a wall to steady myself. Yet, no matter how much I panicked or how hard I looked, there were no walls within reach. The earthquake-like tremors made it feel as though the ground beneath me was breaking apart, creating a sinkhole within the expanse of white. Still, with trembling knees, I managed to maintain my balance, my body growing accustomed to the powerful shaking.

And then, without warning, the graviton sprang back to life. It spun with such velocity that it would have made even the most daring amusement park enthusiasts weep with joy. I was flung even farther, landing on the ground and now facing the endless expanse above me. As I lay there, I realized that I had reached a point of equilibrium, where the opposing forces of centrifugal and centripetal motion canceled each other out. But the rotation continued, propelling me in a circular path at speeds that defied all comprehension.

Nausea churned in my stomach, but when I tried to vomit, my body refused to cooperate. I felt as if I were having a heart attack, yet my pulse miraculously returned to normal. The sensation of imminent fainting washed over me, but my body refused to succumb, trapped in this relentless cycle of rotation. The jolts of vibration from the ground shot up my spine, leaving me feeling utterly helpless. In that moment, I couldn't help but berate myself

for not studying physics more diligently. If only I were more adept, perhaps I could calculate an escape velocity from this nightmarish predicament. But this was a rotational motion problem of the most challenging kind—one that not even the most ardent engineering enthusiast could solve.

The abuse continued relentlessly, stretching on for what felt like an eternity. Time seemed impossible to gauge in this vast expanse of white. And then, as suddenly as it had begun, everything came to a halt. A sense of warmth spread through me, akin to the feeling I experienced when I was near someone I cherished. It was in that moment that a voice, soothing yet authoritative, resonated within me.

“My child, your fate has caused grief among your fellow mortals, yet I found enjoyment in the plunge you took toward the iron tower. However, I am not here to engage in conversation. I have shifted a mere 15% of my presence to witness what kind of hell a mortal human creates after succumbing to the weight of their own thoughts. Most humans are responsible for crafting their own hells, drowning in guilt. And those who are not consumed by guilt create their own heavens, only to blame us for the path that leads them there.”

With a brief pause, the voice continued, “But I have an offer for you. Your strong will, even after choosing to end your own life, has caught my attention. Your conscious mind may be burdened with guilt, but your subconscious clings to hope and possesses a strength uncommon among mortals. I require individuals like you, and thus, I present you with an offer.”

Curiosity mingled with anticipation, compelling me to

listen intently. The voice predicted my question before I even uttered it, counting down from three. Without hesitation, I seized the opportunity and blurted out, "Who are you, and where am I?"

"I am what you mortals call God, but my true name is קודש רוח," the voice replied. The words resonated with such power that I felt as if my eardrums were about to burst. Dizziness washed over me, and I struggled to regain my balance. "You are in a reality plane where all departed souls find themselves. However, unlike other souls, your plane remains intact due to your unyielding will, even after taking your own life. That is precisely why I need you to undertake a task for me."

The voice conveyed a touch of concern as it continued, "You see, I created this vast multiverse, interconnected by bridges that allow me to traverse different realms. However, the bridge that connects me to my first world has been damaged and altered, barring my entry. If I were to attempt crossing over, the bridge would be severed permanently, forever isolating me from the web of the multiverse."

Pausing for a moment, the voice explained, "My offer to you is this: Become an agent of God, granted powers by a patron angel. Your mission will be to recover and repair the damaged bridge, and to eliminate the miscreant who defiled it. In exchange, at the completion of this mission, I will allow you to return to your world with a new body, recreated within the first world."

Overwhelmed with a mix of awe and humility, I mustered the courage to speak. "But, my Lord, how can a lowly mortal like me be of use to you, Your Highness?"

The voice, filled with a calm grace, replied, "Though I

cannot predict or alter the future, I can offer you assistance in a different manner. I will grant you the ability to summon three individuals from your world, who will become your allies in the first world.”

I pondered the offer for a brief moment, realizing that it could be a hallucination or a figment of my imagination. Yet, the prospect of embarking on such a thrilling and purposeful journey overwhelmed any doubts. Excitement radiated from every pore of my being as I responded with unwavering determination, “Yes, my Lord. Consider it done.”

3. The Enigmatic Angel

“I appreciate your enthusiasm in becoming a god’s agent, kid, but you must understand the world you’re about to enter overflows with all-penetrating mana. Mana is a potent energy that mortals and monsters alike can channel and manipulate to suit their needs. Due to its nature of being attracted to the life force of an organism, monsters tend to possess large reserves of mana, while humans have a lesser amount. However, humans compensate for this by having better control over their mana, enabling them to wield advanced forms of channeling, resulting in awe-inspiring results. For instance, in my previous reincarnated hero’s case, his summoned party member annihilated nine hundred million monsters with a single spell. This hero was rumored to be the strongest in the entire universe.

Now, I know you must be curious about what happened to that person and what awaits you after completing your mission of defeating the antagonist. Your task will be to repair the world’s bridge and establish a new breed of aristocrats, just as the last hero did after eliminating the elemental lesser gods. Once you accomplish this, you will be able to return.”

Conversing with God was always overwhelming. His omniscience and omnipotence frightened me more than any challenge I had ever faced. One wrong move, and he could erase me with a mere thought.

“Don’t worry, my hero. I am omnipresent, and my choices are infallible,” he said with a playful tone. “Now,

you must meet the angel who will serve as your patron. He will provide further explanations. I hope you fulfill my bidding well, and remember, I can erase you in the blink of an eye.” With those words, the resounding voice faded away, leaving me in shock. God’s voice was humble, yet it exuded power that could shatter worlds.

Encountering someone so far beyond my level made me painfully aware of my own weakness. It was not the first time I had met someone vastly more powerful than myself, but this encounter emphasized my insignificance. I knew I could not hope to compete with God, or even be considered strong in the vastness of the universe.

Before I could fully comprehend the situation, a new voice echoed through the white expanse. I turned to see a captivating man before me—resplendent and powerful. His features were not just handsome; they were timeless and perfect, like a divine creation. His copper-glowing skin and the dazzling blue shades of his eyes left me mesmerized.

“Brother, I agree that we exist in a reality boundless by infinite time. But I don’t have all day, so come near to me,” the angel said in a casual yet deep voice that resonated within my bones. Eager to comply, I ran towards him, curiosity and awe overwhelming me.

“You keep calling me brother, but I have never seen you before,” I said, trying to understand the connection he claimed we had.

“Obviously, you are my brother now, as we follow the same cause. You have been directly chosen by my father, which makes us brothers in arms. I am the archangel of strength, warriors, and known as the God’s judgment. I will be your patron,” he explained, his presence radiating

power and confidence.

The mention of his angelic powers piqued my interest. "What powers will I gain from being under God's judgment?"

"You will possess enhanced speed, thought processing, vitality, durability, super healing, angelic strength, the ability to wield the Weapon-God skill, and the divine judgment. But remember, dude, chill! If you weren't compatible with me, some other angel might have burned you to the ground for your impatience," the archangel responded nonchalantly.

Curiosity sparked within me, and I couldn't resist asking, "What makes you so special, sir, and what do you mean by 'compatible'?"

He chuckled before answering, "Well, I am the youngest archangel, and God has deemed me the best and strongest. Being compatible means that you and I are a perfect match. Angels are assigned to heroes based on their personality and life force. You're lucky to be compatible with me, an archangel, instead of some minor angel like the angel of lies or something... maybe an angel of suicide, who knows?"

Grateful for his support, I confessed, "Sir, I am truly honored, but I feel I lack enough knowledge about the new world. Can you enlighten me further?"

He smirked, his smile taking on a devilish edge, "Where's the fun in telling you everything? My father chose you as a hero for a reason, and I want to see what he saw in you. You'll have to discover more on your own. Just remember, you're about to enter the most challenging world in the universe, a place with powers rivaling angels and God."

As if to emphasize his words, the archangel directed his attention to a particular spot in the white expanse. Suddenly, the room shifted, and a gate emerged before us. He warned me that once I entered the gate, I couldn't return. "You're not that lucky, you know. There have been many reincarnations before you. Your special case is that you're going into the hardest world in the universe—a place with powers that rival angels and God," he said mysteriously.

Without warning, he grabbed me by the collar and threw me into the gate. I felt a mix of fear and excitement as I crashed into it. The gate opened, and I was whisked away into a world tinged with blue, leaving behind the white expanse and the enigmatic archangel.

As I journeyed into the unknown, I couldn't help but feel a rush of emotions. Fear and uncertainty mingled with determination and curiosity, propelling me forward into the new world where I was to face challenges beyond my wildest dreams. The power of gods and angels loomed ahead, and I knew my journey would be extreme, filled with hardships and triumphs. But deep within, a spark of hope and purpose burned bright, reminding me that even in the face of overwhelming power, I had been chosen for a reason—to be a hero, to mend a broken world, and to embrace my destiny in a universe brimming with magic and mystery. Was I ready? 'God knows' but I closed my eyes entering the new world and sharply inhaled.

4. The Divine Free Fall

As I opened my eyes, the realization hit me like a lightning bolt: my archangel had made a grave mistake, and I was hurtling through the sky at an altitude rivaling airplanes. The wind roared in my ears, clothes fluttering wildly, and panic surged within me as I cried out, “Why am I falling again?” But amidst the fear, a glimmer of hope emerged. Deep inside, I knew that keeping my wits about me might just be the key to survival. After all, I had faced such situations before, and I reminded myself that composure was my ally – though it hadn’t helped yet, it was good to keep reminding myself.

As the clouds dispersed, an awe-inspiring sight met my eyes. Towering trees, colossal in size, stood before me, some reaching so high that their branches caressed the clouds like long-lost friends. With determination and quick thinking, I spotted a chance for survival. “That tree right there,” I declared aloud, formulating a plan. “I can grab it to slow my fall and leap to the next one. It’s a slim chance, but I won’t go down without a fight. After all, it’s my second chance.” I was desperate not to die this time around because I wanted to make an impact; last time, I didn’t leave a mark in the world of my name, but it would change this time. As I was contemplating this, an ethereal creature soared gracefully beneath the clouds—a legendary dragon. Its majestic wings shimmered in the sunlight, and its iridescent scales mesmerized me. An audacious idea struck me, and I proclaimed, “I will land on the dragon!” Adjusting my trajectory, I aimed for the

mighty beast. But my daring move didn't go unnoticed. The dragon perceived me as a threat, or maybe a snack, and prepared to devour me.

Yet, in the face of danger, I didn't plan to stop or change my trajectory using its mouth as a way. I knew that would lead to certain death. The only solution was to follow my original plan. As I reached the dragon's oral cavity, I decided that I had to do something about its massive tongue. I fought with all my might, but it seemed futile at first. Then, something inside me awakened – my heart beat raced, and suddenly, I found a newfound strength. With determination, I pulled with all my might and ripped its tongue out from its mouth, causing the dragon to convulse in agony. But my task wasn't complete—the dragon could still crush me with its powerful jaws.

With unwavering determination, I pushed against the jaws that threatened to crush me. The strength that I had just displayed vanished as quickly as it came; I knew I had no chance of winning a battle of strength with a monster related to alligators and possessing a bite force stronger than them. I was about to give up when I remembered what the divine being had said – this world had a magical power called mana that manifested itself in everyone, even in me. If my body was tailor-made by a divine being, it must have an unseen amount of mana. Racing my thoughts, I focused on the dragon's jaw and, when it closed its mouth again, I caught its soft palate, trying to keep those jaws from crushing me. As I looked inside myself, I didn't find anything magical or divine in my existence – just plain old me in a world where dangers were more than I could handle. As I was about to be

crushed by the jaws' force, a sudden rush of adrenaline surged into my stomach, and my muscles felt hot, as if they were being remade. Then the unimaginable occurred—the dragon's jaws yielded, splitting the creature in two. A cascade of emotions washed over me—awe, shock, and irritation—but there was no time to feel anything. I was yet again falling, this time into a picturesque lake that stretched out before me like an azure paradise. A moment of serenity amidst chaos. As I reached the water's surface, the impact was tremendous. I closed my eyes, but I noticed that my body managed to stay in one piece after that impact. I submerged, the force of the dive carrying me deep into the tranquil embrace of the lake. I opened my eyes as I neared the bottom of the lake. There were parts of the dragon there, and something in that corpse shined, piquing my curiosity. I knew that dragon's tooth had many magical uses, chief among them being the ability to grant courage, and I needed it. I had been a coward all my life, so I swam deeper towards the bottom of the lake where the corpse lay, and that's when I realized it wasn't a tooth that glowed so brightly – it was a claw, as huge as my hand. This claw radiated a pearl-white glow. It took time for me to notice, but that lake wasn't devoid of aquatic life – they were just trying to avoid me, maybe because I killed this massive creature or perhaps because they hadn't seen a human before. They kept away from me, which I didn't mind, but I was amazed by the beauty of the schools of fish of different colors that matched the palette of the rainbow.

Suddenly, out of nowhere, a shadow hid the sun that gleamed above the waters of the lake. That shadow was long and snake-like – a huge sea serpent circling in for the

kill. I knew I wasn't ready to confront another mythical being in the element they were strongest in, so I grabbed the glowing claw, used my knees to push myself up to the surface of the lake at a different location than the serpent. It didn't take me long to reach the surface, but I was sure that my lung capacity wasn't this huge at any point in my life. Unfortunately, the sea serpent was still there, swimming around the surface about 50 feet away to my left. Then I dived again to confirm that the sea serpent was long gone. As I looked around underwater, I saw no sign of the sea serpent, and I thought the problem was long gone. But I forgot to look directly down, and just as I was about to swim away to the surface, the sea serpent was right below me, coming in for the kill. The only option I had was to swim and dodge him, which is what I started to do. I swam for my life as the sea serpent followed me, being right behind me at any given moment. I did all the strokes I knew, butterfly, freestyle, but then I let my inner instincts guide me. I dived a bit below the surface for faster swimming, dodging the sea serpent's bite by changing my direction. It was enough, and as I resurfaced, I saw that land was just within my reach. The sea serpent jumped out of the water and bit me, but I was suddenly faced with two choices – keep my arm and die with it, or leave the area the serpent was biting with him and pull myself away. Both options were painful, but I didn't want to die, and I was sure I couldn't do anything with my arm, so I decided to let him pull me deep into the lake. Suddenly, he left my arm and swam back to whatever hellhole he came from. I didn't know why he left me, but I felt a sinister presence lurking – it was in the same magnitude as my dear archangel but opposite in nature. I

didn't know what it was, but as I pulled myself to the shore, I saw my knees give up. When I looked around at the beautiful expanse, I was on a lake shore, with lush green plains more vibrant than any green I had seen on my earth. In front of me were mountains as tall as clouds and more, touching the clouds as if they were more dominant, claiming victory. To my left was a deep, deep redwood jungle, and to my right was a pathway that led to some sort of clearing in the plains. I needed practice making decisions because I couldn't decide what I should do. The most obvious choice was to take the pathway, but that would lead me to some kind of civilization, and I didn't know how conversation worked here. I thought about heading into the woods, but then the dangers lurking there were unknown. So, I was stuck at this lakeshore until I made up my mind.

5. Divine Borrowed Power?

As I sat there, basking in the ethereal warmth of the sun, I consciously immersed myself in the awe-inspiring world surrounding me. The realization slowly descended upon my soul, like a celestial revelation, that my ambitious quest to win the favor of a deity was an endeavor far beyond the realm of my imagination. The power to shape my destiny lay solely in the hands of a god, yet here I stood, humbly entangled in the eternal struggle between those who triumphed and those who faltered.

Undeterred by the enormity of the task, I had embarked on a selfless endeavor, daring to face and slay a dragon—a mythical creature undoubtedly more deserving of life than myself. Contemplating the vastness of the universe and the inherent limitations that even a god might face, I found myself questioning the very boundaries of divine power. Could the celestial beings mend everything with a mere snap of their fingers, or were there cosmic rules they, too, had to respect?

As I gracefully rose from my serene spot on the shore, I gently brushed off the clinging grains of sand that adorned my clothes. It was at that precise moment that my vision underwent a wondrous transformation. It felt as though the very fabric of space had shifted its hue, and as I held my own hand before me, I noticed an extraordinary change. My vision now possessed a polarized quality, with the outline of my hand taking on a striking blue hue. Every movement appeared to unfold frame by frame, as if

my eyes had been blessed with a divine upgrade to a higher resolution.

Curiosity, like a siren's call, beckoned me to explore how this newfound vision would unveil the celestial canopy above. As I focused on the heavens, they appeared almost abstract in shape and color. But with diligent observation, I discerned smaller shapes dancing within my field of view. These enigmatic forms, though challenging to decipher, seemed to convey vital information about my own being—the status of my mana reserve and health. This knowledge, undeniably useful, couldn't entirely suppress the rising anxiety within me. Knowing the precise extent of my health meant that it could decrease, potentially leading to pain—a prospect that filled me with trepidation. Memories of suffering in my past life haunted me, culminating in the poignant decision to end it all.

Yet, the fear of pain now drove me to seek a way to avoid it at all costs. As I hesitated and procrastinated, a mysterious presence seemed to materialize behind me, interrupting my thoughts and stirring a mix of dread and resentment. I turned to face this unexpected visitor, and there stood a young man, seemingly a stranger from another realm. He exuded an air of charm and confidence, his red shirt artfully revealing his chiseled abs, and his jeans and matching black shoes completing a striking ensemble. His well-built form, a stark contrast to my own scrawniness, sparked a tinge of envy, as I had often been a target for those who wielded their strength over me.

His captivating red irises held my gaze, and while they seemed a puzzling juxtaposition to his appearance, I paid little mind to it, for I had resolved to be wary of him—

deeming him nothing more than a gym enthusiast who believed he could push me around. My recent conquest of the dragon had instilled a newfound sense of courage within me, and he said “Greetings, stranger. It might be impolite to inquire, but where does your loyalty lies” he said. “If you must know, I hail from a distant kingdom. As for my loyalty, I am still seeking my path, but rest assured, I do not harbor malevolence in my heart.” I said gently trying to assert my stand of neutrality.

His voice, sweet and captivating, didn’t match his imposing figure, and I found myself momentarily entranced. However, I quickly shook off the enchantment, for I knew I had to be cautious. Before I could continue the conversation, he vanished from my vision, and a strange force tugged at my shoulder blade. In an instant, I found myself soaring upward, my trajectory an enigmatic parabolic flight path. I glimpsed the vast expanse of the land below, filled with both the promise of civilization and the peril of uncertainty.

But there he was again, standing before me as if defying the laws of nature, a testament to his extraordinary abilities. Before I could react, his fist was hurtling towards me with tremendous force. I instinctively raised my hand to block, but the impact was overwhelming. The air around him crackled with raw energy as he launched me skyward once more. The pain surged through me, and I could feel my health bar diminishing rapidly.

Confusion and fear gripped my heart as I tried to make sense of the situation. Was I truly nothing more than a fragile creature, a mere puppet for this enigmatic gym enthusiast to manipulate at will? The thought was

unsettling, but I refused to succumb to despair. With every ounce of courage, I mustered a resolve to endure, to find a way to counter this overwhelming force. I started calculating my trajectory $V_0^2 \sin^2 \theta / 2g$ or something I was bad at physics even when my life depended on it, as I was trying to focus I saw that the small icons jumping on my view increase but before I could focus on that I had an idea. Determined to escape his relentless onslaught I tried to change my trajectory by changing my drag by spreading my hands, My parabolic trajectory now took on a shuttle-like motion, and I saw a glimmer of hope—an opportunity to reach a distant civilization that might aid me in my plight. As I soared through the sky, aiming for that elusive haven, he once again stood before me, defying my calculations, his eyes gleaming with manic intensity.

Desperation and frustration fueled my next plea. “Stop!” I screamed, hoping to reason with him. But he paid no heed, and his powerful fist collided with my face, altering my trajectory and rendering my calculations futile. With a bone-crushing impact, we crashed onto the land below, he on top of me, the agony radiating through my broken body.

As I lay there, amidst the whirlwind of physical pain and the torment of my dire situation, a newfound clarity washed over me. This battle transcended mere combat; it was a clash of wills, a dance of egos. Vanquish this formidable adversary, I realized I must employ his very ego as a weapon to bring about his downfall.

“They slay one dragon and believe themselves invincible,” he proclaimed with a malevolent grin, jumping with force I didn’t know muscles could gather

soaring into the air and granting me a fleeting chance to rise. But before I could respond, he started descending upon me with the force of 9.8 meters per second squared, a destructive trajectory I could ill afford to confront directly. With a deep breath and focus, I recalled a time-honoured tactic, revered across the realms of martial arts in my world. Instead of moving away I have to face it head on because this tactic was my only way to survive but before I could pull the tactic off, I felt time slow down.

6. The Hound's Ambush

As time seemed to slow its pace around me, a surreal sight unfolded before my eyes. The man exuded not only metaphorical mania but also an actual aura of anger, casting a vivid crimson hue around his body. It reminded me of the way my own movements were accompanied by a gentle outline of blue. Yet, I found myself too preoccupied with the onslaught of being thrown around to fully grasp the power of my polarized vision, capable of being wielded at will. Unfortunately, it offered no respite in this moment as time merely slowed, refusing to halt entirely.

Descending gracefully from the heavens, his ominous approach conveyed an unsettling intention. It appears he sought to crush my lungs or shatter my bones with a force that bordered on absolute. The enigma lay in the details; did he desire a painfully slow demise or was he not truly intent on taking my life? Why perform such a grandiose jump when he could have easily ended me by twisting my neck as I lay defenseless on the ground? Amidst the turmoil, there was no luxury of time to ponder his motives, so I shifted my focus to the practicality of my martial arts lesson, a Complimentary gift by Charlie.

As he drew nearer, a calm resolve washed over me, and I adroitly shifted my balance to my back foot, preparing for the encounter. In one swift motion, I seized his chest and harnessed every ounce of strength within me, skillfully combining the x vector with the y vector's acceleration to unleash a powerful twist. The effect was

immediate; he was taken aback, unable to comprehend the force of torque that brought him crashing to the ground.

Yet, the battle was far from over. My mind raced with determination, and without hesitation, I sprang forward, landing one foot on his chest. Gripping his outstretched hand, I realized the strength I possessed—capable of tearing his limb from his body. However, an internal moral struggle prevailed. How could I, with any moral authority, take another's limb in such a way?

"Jerry, there's no time!" I found myself shouting aloud, reminding myself of the urgent reality at hand. This man's purpose was a mystery—he seems to be on a quest to unravel the secrets of human aerodynamics or a malevolent intent to end my life. And in this crucial moment, I chose that I should act on the latter probability. Amidst the peculiar circumstances and the ethereal slowing of time, I was still a coward I didn't have the strength to do anything right as I stood there his arm in my hand the time regain its momentum and suddenly my ace in the hole was gone "you should have teared it when you had the chance"

In the midst of the tense situation, the mysterious figure's voice rang with an air of intrigue and enigma as he tightened his grip on my forearm. His ethereal speed was astonishing, leaving me breathless and bewildered by his every move. Just as I thought I was about to fall into his grasp, he deftly executed an unorthodox martial art move, flipping me ahead of him and landing on my back with his hand firmly gripping my neck.

"So, hero, are you going to reveal your true potential, or are you just another failed experiment that the Hound Unit is expected to dispose of?" His words flowed with an

unsettling gentleness, as if discussing the weather rather than my imminent fate. I found myself uncertain of how to respond, my hands instinctively raised in surrender while his grip remained unyielding.

In a chilling laughter that sent shivers down my spine, he addressed my confusion, "You see, I may be considered a mere dog of the Supreme Commander, but even Hounds like me have eyes and brains. I observed your dramatic descent from the sky and witnessed your raw strength as you took down that dragon. Combine that with your lack of demi-human features, and it makes you a prime suspect, fleeing to this Dissident Land."

He sneered at the term "Dissident" and continued, "In Hound Unit, we lack the abundance of lifeforce your Royal Unit enjoys. Sacrificing our lifeforce grants us strength, but unlike your impressive abilities, we don't receive any extraordinary gifts. Instead, I was bestowed with the power to transform my limbs into monstrous forms, perfect for dispatching any foe threatening our Supreme Leader and motherland."

His envy was evident, but I couldn't fully grasp all the complexities he spoke of. The notion of lifeforce being relinquished and the idea of "gifts" eluded me. Nonetheless, I decided to cooperate, hoping to find a way out of this dire situation. "I am willing to comply, sir. Just tell me what I need to do," I said, attempting to sound as persuasive as possible.

Mocking me, he responded, "Ah, now the royal kid knows who's in charge. Quite clever, unlike most fugitives I encounter seeking asylum in these lands." His smile held a malevolent edge, hinting at his twisted intentions. "You see, loyal as I am to our motherland, I'm

quite tempted to sell you to the inhabitants of this land. Breaking the refugee treaty will lead to war, and my motherland will purify these lands in the name of the Fourth.”

Curiosity and fear mingled as I dared to question him, “But aren’t you human as well? And what’s with all this talk about elves?”

For a moment, he seemed lost in his grandiose schemes, ignoring my inquiries. Then, regaining focus, he offered me a choice with a sinister tone, “You’ll wear an iron collar, my friend, or you can choose the other option.” His hand transformed into a menacing red claw, making it clear that refusing his offer wasn’t an option to be taken lightly.

As I contemplated my options, he vanished from my sight and materialized behind me, his hand now resting on my shoulder blade. The situation was dire, and my mind raced for any glimmer of hope in this perilous encounter.

7. Bound By Chains

As the hound reappeared behind me, a profound sense of despair sank into my very soul. His cold touch sent shivers down my spine, and the iron collar he had placed around my neck felt like a cruel reminder of my newfound fate. Memories of the isekai I once read flooded my mind – tales of suffering and oppression that had seemed distant fantasies, now my horrifying reality.

The hound's voice, deceptively sweet yet concealing a rotten heart, commanded, "Hurry and start walking. We will take about half a day to get there, and if we get any later, I will personally make sure you don't live to see the upcoming war." In this world, it appeared that slaves were mere pawns in a vicious game of power and dominance, their spirits crushed by a never-ending nightmare of torment and defeat.

Despite my fear, I mustered the courage to respond, my voice trembling with emotion. "Yes, sir, I am ready," I whimpered, trying to shield myself from his cruel kicks. With each step, my heart grew heavier as I left behind the life I once knew – a life of adventure and freedom, now replaced with chains and servitude.

As we trudged through the dense forest, the weight of reality bore down upon me. The beauty of nature surrounding us only served to highlight the ugliness of the world I had been thrust into. Each passing moment felt like an eternity, and the possibility of escaping this nightmare seemed ever more distant.

I gazed back longingly at the serene lakeshore, where

I had once basked in the glory of a recent dragon slaying. Oh, how the mighty had fallen, from dragon slayer to a mere slave, bound to serve a malevolent master with ambitions that threatened to engulf the world in flames.

Thoughts of my loved ones flooded my mind, and tears welled in my eyes. How I yearned to see them once more, to embrace them and express how much I loved them. But here, in this cruel new world, all that awaited me was suffering and loneliness. As we neared the city where my fate would be sealed, hopelessness enveloped me. The prospect of being auctioned off like an object made my heart ache with sorrow. In this sorrowful world, my tears were but drops in an ocean of despair. Before we could reach the city gates, an enchanting facade that concealed the ugliness within, I contemplated how this beautiful exterior was meant to deceive and attract innocent people, keeping them oblivious to the grim truth, serving as fuel for a machine that fed on fear and innocence.

“We will turn east and walk until evening, alongside the wall, until we reach the end of the eastern wall. There, I have ties with the tower guards who are stationed every 200 meters,” the hound said, a tone of self-importance underscoring his words, as if expecting gratitude for sharing this information. My mind worked out the length of the wall, estimating the distance as we walked. The sun wasn’t in the afternoon stage, and it seemed like 11 am, so if I had to walk until 6 pm, that would make it 7 hours of walking. “Seven hours of walking at a speed of 5.1 km/hr makes it 35.7 km, just for one wall. This means the city covers at least 1274.49 km²,” I said, my mind calculating slowly.

“I don’t know what gibberish you are saying,” the

hound replied, glaring at me with his red eyes, seemingly trying to discern the source of my knowledge, as if surprised by my intelligence. "Are you privy to forbidden knowledge, accessible only to scientists?" he asked, anger seething in his voice, as he realized that my words might have some logical basis. In his rage, his hand transformed into a demonic form, a power bestowed upon him by some unknown gift. He grabbed my hand and stabbed his nail into my ulnar artery, causing blood to gush out, and I cried out in pain. "What was that for?" I demanded.

"For uttering state secret knowledge in a non-secure area. Next time you put my motherland in danger like this, this bleeding will be from your neck," he said, radiating malevolence. I complied with his command and walked until the sun fell. However, I soon realized my earlier estimate of the wall's length was incorrect. It seemed far longer than I had calculated. As we continued walking, I noticed that the wall was constructed entirely of white limestone, intricately interconnected in a pattern reminiscent of Roman engineering. Perhaps this land was the Roman equivalent of a fantasy world.

"I know what you are thinking," said the hound as the sun set, and we approached our destination.

"And what might that be, sir?" I asked, employing a hint of polite sarcasm.

"How the mighty empire came into a treaty with these fugitives," he replied, acknowledging my thoughts. It had struck me as odd that there was no border or border police from either side of this opposition, given the empire's apparent hatred for this land.

"I know that royal unit brats like you don't leave the labs until you have been given your gifts. However,

hounds like us are picked from the border villages for expertise in terrain, so I know a lot about this world far more than you can imagine,” he said, pride glimmering in his eyes as if he held superiority due to his knowledge. He seemed unaware that he was the one selling me as a slave, even as he provided information that might help me escape this life of servitude.

“Sir, can you tell me why there is a treaty between our motherland and this area?” I inquired, attempting to maintain a polite tone.

“The first reincarnated hero – I’m sure you’ve heard of him,” he asked, locking his gaze with mine. I knew that denying knowledge would only provoke him further, so I replied, “Yes, sir, he is my hero.” However, this response seemed to trigger his rage, and he judo-flipped me and seized my arm. “Take that back, or your arm will be taken from you,” he said sternly.

“That was sarcasm, my dear sir,” I hurriedly explained, recognizing that he despised the first reincarnated hero.

“Oh, okay,” he said, demonstrating his lack of intelligence outside the battlefield. He continued speaking, recounting the hero’s actions, how he had killed 900 million monsters and used their souls to create a system called the index of magic. This system granted power to all races, even demi-humans. His tone oozed disgust as he mentioned the demi-humans, revealing his disdain for them.

“Additionally, the hero founded this Land of Half-Breeds, which includes races like elves and vampires. These races possess mana of a monster and manipulating capabilities far superior to humans in our world. It makes

conquering this land incredibly difficult, as one of their kind is equivalent to a thousand humans. However, our motherland has produced us, the demons, capable of matching and even surpassing these monstrous creatures. We are the answer to their power," he declared. But before he could elaborate further, he halted, gazing at the white wall before us. "Oh, I didn't notice. We have reached our destination," he said with a glint of happiness in his eyes he was pleased of himself. "so Now I get sold" I mumbled.

8. On The Wall's Brim

As the hound stopped at our destination, he looked up, his hair sweeping across his face. He brushed the strands away and shouted, "Do not play games! Even though I do not have mana sense, I can smell you, bastard!" A different voice replied, "I hope you have the money, hound. So, you better show me the respect I deserve, or I can ring the alarm, and the whole Valkyrie unit will be here." The voice carried an alarming and aggressive tone, and it was evident that no one liked the hound who had bound me in chains.

"Oh, okay, I am sorry," the hound said, now humbled in his tone. It surprised me to see him show humility towards the person he was speaking to, implying that this person was even stronger than him. I turned my attention to the figure approaching us, a black silhouette descending from the wall. As the figure stood before me, the evening light revealed a man as tall as me, but with pale skin. His pupils appeared as a mesmerizing vertical slit, while his sclera bore a haunting shade of grey, and his irises emanated an intense, luminous yellow, exuding an unmistakable aura of strength.

"So, who are you?" he asked, without looking directly at me.

"I am the slave who is about to be sold," I replied. His interest seemed piqued as he was about to say something, but then he paused. "Curious, but I want to see where this takes you," he said with a grin on his face. I turned to the hound for an explanation.

"This is your majesty, Lord Sula de Koss, one of the last 15 true vampires," the hound explained. I gazed at the newly introduced Lord, and he continued, "Please, call me Koss." There was an inexplicable power imbued in his voice, almost commanding me to bend on one knee, and instinctively, I complied, kneeling before him.

"Oh, I love it when an inferior blood bag like you knows their place, but the same cannot be said for this sour spot right over there," said the vampire. As I looked behind me, I saw the hound still standing up tight, looking ready to fight at any moment. However, he knew that clashing with the vampire would disrupt his own plot, so he remained silent and knelt on one knee right next to me. His face showed the utter disgust he was feeling while bowing down.

"When faced with danger, animals have two instincts: they either flock together or develop themselves to overcome the threat," the vampire said unironically. He lifted himself off the ground gracefully, a sight that seemed straight out of science fiction, but to be honest, everything in this surreal place felt like it was from another world.

Suddenly, he turned his back on us, facing the wall, and zoomed over it, leaving us behind. "Follow on, blood bag!" he shouted with a flicker of joy in his voice. The hound looked at me as he stood up, offering his hand to help me off the ground—a polite gesture I hadn't expected from him.

"You see, my friend, this is why we must eradicate these so-called demi-humans," he explained passionately. "Our motherland has granted us, the hounds, the power to stand on equal footing with those elusive elves. However,

it is the might of our royal unit that can truly put vampires back in their castles, even amidst the darkest shadows. Believe in yourself, my friend, for you possess the power to do good. I assure you, I never intended to harm you during our duel. Instead, I sought to awaken your innate gift. Sometimes, such gifts take time to manifest clearly, but trust that the motherland's wisdom guides us."

He spoke with a hint of humility, as though recalling an unsettling encounter with a bat that had left a lasting impression on him. "I don't have all night," the lord's commanding voice called from high above, prompting the hound to give a thumbs-up before bending his knees, preparing for a tremendous leap.

As an athlete prepares to jump, he propelled himself into the air, the first jump appearing within human capabilities—around two meters high, a feat many could achieve. However, what followed left me utterly astonished. With raw power and unmatched strength, the hound leaped once more, defying all expectations. The ground itself seemed awestruck by his breathtaking achievement as he soared, effortlessly scaling a colossal 20-meter-tall wall made of pristine white stone. His muscular prowess evoked both fear and admiration.

Upon reaching the top, he called out, "Follow on," as if jumping such heights was a regular occurrence in this extraordinary country. Yet, I knew better. It defied all conventional logic to erect such a towering wall. My heart raced with excitement and trepidation, for I had no idea how to follow suit.

"How can I possibly jump this high?" I asked, my voice tinged with uncertainty.

"Just jump," he replied, a touch of irritation in his tone.

I sensed his impatience but also understood that he believed in royal unit potential.

Taking a deep breath, I visualized myself surmounting the obstacle before me. All doubts and fears seemed to fade away as determination filled my veins. I summoned every ounce of courage, channelling the power within me that the hound had sought to awaken even though they weren't the one he expected this was my chance to be one with the power I was given by the divine.

I attempted a jump, but it turned out to be nothing more than pathetic. It seemed that all the muscular power within me could barely propel me a mere 10 cm through the air. I couldn't help but question if some malfunctioning powers were bestowed upon me, as I simply couldn't believe my incompetence with the abilities I had. Despite never using them willingly, this feeling of inadequacy haunted me.

In the midst of my self-doubt, the vampire approached from the wall. He appeared to be indifferent to my feelings as he spoke, "Even though the hound insists you're a mere pawn in this game, I doubt a pawn who couldn't even move one step at a time is of any use to the motherland." Tears welled up in my eyes he was targeting me like he could read me he knew I wanted to feel needed, as I gazed at him, realizing he was provoking me. He wanted me to fight him, to take on the hound, though his motivations remained unknown. While he might be an ally, he was no friend; this vampire possessed a sinister nature of his own. Although he wasn't hunting me presently, I knew the status quo could change for the worse if I allowed my emotions to overpower me.

"I apologize, my lord, for finding myself in this

situation, but I am merely a powerless slave. Please, enlighten me on how such a pathetic being like myself can overcome this wall,” I replied, laced with dripping sarcasm. Such confrontations were not unfamiliar to me, having dealt with haughty individuals during my school days, a skill I had honed.

“Oh, I love it when people know their place,” he replied with a proud expression. “Allow me to show you the pinnacle of power there is.” His black and yellow eyes gleamed in the night, exuding a predatory desire.

For a few seconds, I was bewildered, trying to grasp the situation. When I felt myself lifted off the ground, I knew something was amiss. It was then that I recognized the person standing before me—a vampire. He effortlessly wielded his telekinesis, and as I was taken up by this eerie force of nature, he flew back up without a care in the world. I found myself on the wall shortly after, but those fleeting moments made me realize how outclassed I truly was. The vampire possessed absolute control over the x, y, and z vectors of this power, all without even needing to look. Meanwhile, I couldn’t even defeat a hound. Despite my fear, I understood that he could snap my neck just as easily as he lifted me from the ground.

“Weaker beings can be manipulated by those with exponentially more mana than them. It’s simply a matter of controlling the mana that one radiates from their skin. For those who lack mana, this won’t work. So, don’t go telling that hound that you flew up here by my telekinesis, or he’ll surely catch on to the deception,” a voice echoed in my head. I was certain it belonged to the vampire, yet when I scanned my surroundings, he was nowhere to be

seen. Great, he could infiltrate my mind as well. Still, I had no time to worry as I finally reached the top of the wall.

9. The Veil Of Melancholy

As I stood atop the wall, several things immediately caught my attention. Firstly, the wall's width was designed to accommodate guards' patrols, an obvious feature. Secondly, as I gazed out at the city beyond, I was struck by its grandeur—easily matching, if not surpassing, the magnificence of the towering white wall. A vast expanse of mansions with individual gardens sprawled before me. Some structures exuded an ancient charm, while others appeared as fresh as a newlywed bride. Clearly, residing within these walls demanded a life of grandeur, for everything about this place exuded opulence. Each mansion had its own spacious garden, unencumbered by concerns of space. They seemed to prioritize living lavishly without any compromise.

I shifted my gaze downwards, and to my surprise, I discovered a market lining the foot of the wall. The stalls stretched all along the base, a lively and bustling setting. However, a peculiar observation left me bewildered—the entire market appeared to be in a state of standstill. Despite the vibrant arrangement and placement of the stalls, a profound silence enveloped the scene. Not a single lamp illuminated any of the stalls, rendering the area devoid of life.

The contrast between the lavish mansions and the motionless market intrigued me. It seemed that while grandeur and abundance thrived within the walls of the mansions, an enigmatic stillness had befallen the marketplace.

"If you're done sightseeing, can we proceed, brat?" called the hound from afar. As I looked in his direction, I noticed he was inside a peculiar Bartizan, unlike any I had seen before. It lacked the small holes usually present for arrows and bullets. Nevertheless, I obeyed and started walking towards it.

"I must understand; you are awestruck by the architecture of our kingdom," said the vampire as soon as I entered the Bartizan, sporting a smile that seemed more like a grin of supremacy. "Anyway, I am going to my castle. The sun will dawn upon us in an hour. If you get caught, I will simply say that I went home an hour early because I am an endangered species," he said with a condescending tone. Strangely, he then pulled out a small cylinder from his Sunday suit, shaped like a pocket watch.

"See," he said, shoving the watch close to my nose. To my surprise, I could read it clearly. The watch had an obsidian face with three golden hands, and the numbers were in Roman numerals made out of rubies. The time displayed was 3:30, which meant two things: I had been walking for much longer than I realized, and the definition of "evening" needed a little adjustment.

"Okay, so I take my leave," the vampire suddenly declared, floating away from the gate I came from.

"This was a very strange behaviour of that bastard vampire," said the hound, watching the bat as it flew away. "He was just rubbing in the fact that this kingdom has something called 'time,' which they measure using those strange circles. They once gifted our supreme ruler, the son of the fourth, with this strange circle, and since then, it has become a tradition for them to show their circles every time they meet someone from our land," he

said, glancing at me. Then, he proceeded further inside the Bartizan.

Inside, there was a bed, a room for a loo, and a trapdoor. Knowing the hound well, I was certain he was not going in there for the loo. "This city is guarded both by magic and muscle power," the hound said mysteriously, opening the trapdoor. "The inner part of this wall has a barrier so you can't enter the city by leaping over it. For mana-less beings like us, this is not a problem. However, there is some sort of holy kingdom magic that they acquired a few years ago, which guards the barrier as well. My captain said that 'if you want to enter the city, you need to go through the trapdoor,' which led to the idea for the betterment of the motherland and the very idea that has brought us here, my friend," he explained.

But some of his words were beyond my understanding. He proclaimed he was mana-less, yet the gods themselves told me that mana was all-penetrating, and everyone had it. Moreover, what is this holy kingdom? How many political rivals are there, and if they all have such security and manpower, why do they need someone like me to be a slave?

The hound's explanation left me with more questions than answers, the ones he did not bother to answer. He went into the trapdoor, and I, putting my anxiety away, followed him. The trapdoor opened up to a long staircase that led down to the ground level. The stairs themselves were made of iron and painted to prevent rust, but how the people around here had technology from our world was a mystery to me. And I was no Sherlock.

As we went down the stairs, we were met by a wooden door that looked worn out from years of usage. The hound

wasted no time in opening it. "We will go left from here until the sun comes up, and then we'll find the slave trader there," he said with certainty as we stepped out of the wall and into the city. The air was filled with the scents of various flowers and trees that thrived here. Taking in the wondrous aroma, I turned to the hound and asked, "Shall we start walking?" But before the hound could answer, something shattered the peaceful ambiance the city maintained. Suddenly, the market, which was still like stone moments ago, was filled with lights, and numerous black figures appeared from nowhere and everywhere. It seemed like we had been caught in an ambush.

The situation took a dangerous turn, and I could feel the tension in the air as we stood surrounded by these mysterious figures. What would happen next, I could only wonder.

The hound was no stranger to combat; his experience and skills as a soldier were evident as soon as the black figures appeared. With a swift transformation, his hands turned into demonic forms. Without hesitation, he leaped into the fray, meeting the attackers head-on.

His movements were like a deadly dance, as he unleashed a barrage of punches, kicks, and grapples upon his adversaries. Each strike was precise, aimed at vulnerable spots that could incapacitate his opponents swiftly. He twisted and turned, avoiding incoming attacks with a combination of agility and instinct.

As the combatants closed in on him, he struck with brutal efficiency. His fists connected with flesh and bone, sending shockwaves of pain through the assailants. He grabbed one by the neck, using their own momentum against them and throwing them into another attacker.

Another vicious kick sent another stumbling backward, unable to regain their balance.

However, the fight took a gruesome turn as the assailants began to regenerate. Despite the damage the hound inflicted, they kept coming back, and their numbers seemed to be increasing. Their resilience and eerie persistence started to wear on the hound's endurance.

Blood began to stain the ground, a testament to the ferocity of the battle. The hound's face was streaked with sweat and determination, but also hints of exhaustion. He fought on, unwilling to yield, but the relentless onslaught was taking its toll.

With every strike he delivered, the assailants seemed to come back stronger and more vicious. They pulled out swords like katana which tore into the hound's flesh, leaving deep gashes that oozed crimson. Despite his best efforts, he found it increasingly difficult to keep up the fight.

The hound's movements started to slow, and his once precise strikes became more desperate. He was fighting against the odds, but he refused to back down.

The assailants continued to swarm around him, pressing their advantage. They sensed his weakening state and capitalized on it, hoping to overpower the hound completely. But even in the midst of adversity, the hound never lost his determination, his will to survive, and protect me.

In the face of overwhelming odds, the hound continued to battle valiantly. His resilience and fighting spirit were awe-inspiring, even in the midst of this harrowing combat. But the question lingered – how much longer could he hold out against this relentless onslaught?

The hound's response came swiftly, cutting off any further discussion. "I am a son of the motherland. I shall not die without killing all of you!" he declared before collapsing to the ground. His face flushed with anger, blood oozing from his chest as the assailants closed in, eager to finish him off. "This world demands sacrifices. I will offer what's left of my life and body for the greater good of the motherland!" he bellowed, pulling his left arm out and waving it in the air. An intense aura enveloped him, reminiscent of the one I had witnessed in the presence of the angel. The surrounding area grew hotter, the middle of the night seemingly ablaze. Before I could react, a feminine voice echoed from behind me.

"Oh no, you don't!" she yelled. As I looked at her, she was gorgeous with her stunning reddish-brown hair. Her regal black gown was a masterpiece of elegance and sophistication. The rich, velvety fabric clung to her figure like a second skin, accentuating her curves with allure. Its obsidian hue absorbed the surrounding light, creating an aura of mystery and intrigue. As she walked, a radiant aura of power seemed to emanate from her. But I feared it was too late, for the area was turning unbearably warm. Yet, the lady suddenly halted in her tracks, ready to intervene and confront the impending danger with her whatever she got

She gracefully waved her hands, and in an instant, she was surrounded by a mesmerizing display of circles, spheres, and triangles. Each ethereal shape exuded a radiant blue hue, as if imbued with otherworldly power. With a pointed finger, the woman directed her magic towards the hound's golden aura. The shapes transformed into mysterious letters, some familiar like alpha and

omega, while others remained enigmatic. These letters surged towards the hound, seemingly inscribing an ancient script in the air. I braced myself for a fiery explosion, but instead, the flames merged with the mystical words, creating a protective wall of energy around him. It was an extraordinary spectacle, an awe-inspiring display of magic beyond comprehension.

After completing her task of stopping the hound's impending explosion, she turned her back, ready to leave. But then, she suddenly looked back, her gaze intense. "There is another source of mana, feeble compared to mine, but a lot more than what you guys can handle here," said the lady to the black assailants. Turning back to face them, she stepped into the light, and I could see her features more clearly. Her sharp, Asian-like features were mesmerizing. Her eyes glowed in the darkness, a captivating mix of red and white unlike the lord vampire's black and yellow irises.

As I stood there, she approached me, gently touching my cheek with her finger, "So, you are the mana source I was looking for." Her voice was alluring, and I was spellbound. "But Koss' reports say you are just a lowly soldier boy who underwent the same process as the hounds. Yet, you possess mana beyond the level of half-elves." She smiled at me before turning her attention back to the assailants, whom she referred to as half-elves. "Take him to the interrogation room!" she commanded, and suddenly, darkness enveloped me as I lost consciousness.

10. Dance Of Politics

As I slowly regained consciousness, I found myself facing a grey wall in a dimly lit cell. The words etched on the wall revealed the absence of the universal declaration of human rights. "I am innocent, it's been 5 days, they torture," read one of many petroglyphs left by previous prisoners. Voices echoed from multiple directions. "Please, I am innocent!" cried a woman. "You are innocent, then I am a human!" shouted a man, followed by the sound of whipping, intensifying the despair. Unable to bear their cries for help, I shifted my focus and rose to my feet, taking in the bleak surroundings. The classic iron grid blocked any view beyond, encapsulating the hopelessness within. In this grim place, uncertainty loomed—how long would I be trapped in this abyss of sorrow and suffering? The echoes of torment persisted, haunting reminders of the sombre reality.

Before I could indulge in a poetic battle of thoughts about how this prison treated immigrants, especially me, poorly and how I might escape, I heard the cliché iron grid's lock opening. My attention turned to that direction. "So, this is the mystery that the witch was talking about," proclaimed a feminine voice before entering my cell. As she stepped inside, in the dark I could barely make out her features, even those left me in awe. Her presence exuded an aura of authority and power, contrasting with the gloom of the prison.

As she slowly approached, I got a complete view. She wore a formal white shirt adorned with medals, signifying

her high rank. Her black pants and matching boots exuded authority. Her sharp features resembled a stereotypical Californian beauty. However, it was her ears that caught my attention, and suddenly, everything made sense.

She was an elf; her pointy ears confirmed that I was in a kingdom where their race held superiority over me. Her two-toned hair added to her enigmatic presence, with black roots flowing down to her chin, and the rest of her hair shimmering in a captivating shade of green, reminiscent of the lush trees they grew up in this walled up city.

Mesmerized by her beauty, I found myself entrapped as she firmly gripped my t-shirt's collar. "So, convict, before we cut your head off and be done with this mess, speak what you must," she demanded. Attempting to meet her gaze was a challenge, given her towering height of at least half a foot over me. Fear of a brutal demise lingered, casting a shadow over my every thought.

"I am innocent!" I yelled, my voice echoing through the cold, dimly lit cell. Despite knowing my plea might be dismissed as clichéd, I couldn't suppress the desperation in my tone. The prison director, a tall and imposing elf with stunning two-toned hair, grabbed my t-shirt's collar, her eyes gleaming with authority.

"We are well aware of your innocence," she stated, her voice carrying an air of otherworldly wisdom. "But what we seek to unravel is the purpose of keeping you alive amidst the impending war. You, the enigmatic catalyst of this brewing conflict, has managed to put fate of our great nation, Seyleprus on risk. As the prison director, the burden of our realm's future rests upon my shoulders, and I refuse to indulge in needless bloodshed. Our heritage,

built on the sacred principles of co-existence and peace, guides our every action.”

Her words hung in the air like a haunting melody, weaving an intricate tapestry of fate.

In the midst of her anger, I dared to pose a question, my voice carrying an air of curiosity tinged with apprehension. “You claim to know of my innocence, yet you accuse me of being the one who brewed this war,” I inquired, attempting to sound composed despite the mounting tension in the air.

Her steely gaze locked onto mine as she spoke with regal authority, “Indeed, your innocence is apparent from the intactness of your mana, ruling out any association with the heinous Regenspire dictatorship scientists and their gruesome experiments. You are not from Regenspire; that much is clear. The only plausible explanation is that you and the hound are the product of a new political alliance between the holy empire and the dictatorship. Or, intriguingly, you may hail from another world entirely. Your attire, the garments worn in the holy empire are too different these clothes you worn is a local specialty of our nation.”

Her words ignited a whirlwind of thoughts in my mind, as I grappled with the implications of her deductions. My cover was blown, and now I stood at a crossroads. I could either reveal the truth about being a god's agent and risk prosecution as a war criminal, or I could maintain my facade and hope they dismiss my claim as delusional ramblings.

Summoning my courage, I decided honesty was the best course. “I am what you may call a god's agent, sent here by divine will to repair and recover the holy bridge

that connects your realm to the divine,” I confessed, hoping my words would find some understanding.

To my surprise, the elven woman seemed to entertain the idea. “Yes, that can be a sensible deduction. So, we must take you to the matriarch of the elven council,” she declared, turning to her hidden guards.

Before the guards could act, another voice, familiar and haunting, echoed in the dimly lit chamber. “Why not to the matriarch of the vampiric council?” It was Lord Koss, the vampire who had captured me.

A tense exchange ensued as the two formidable beings engaged in a verbal duel, their words laced with pride and power. Koss seemed eager to represent me before his matriarch, while the elven woman remained resolute in her duty to her matriarch.

Amidst the political turmoil, I interjected, “Why not take me to both of them? Surely, as the supreme members of your respective councils, they must meet to discuss this matter.”

The suggestion hung in the air as they both regarded me. “Newcomer, you don’t know much about politics, do you?” the elf director inquired, her tone condescending. “You see, blood-bag,” Lord Koss chimed in, using his usual derogatory term, “this kingdom was built with a specific system. All demi-humans form a council called the Council of the Kingdom. However, elves and vampires are granted special privileges. They form their own council with the right to vote on matters brought before the Council of the Kingdom. Additionally, they can interject if they believe the Council of the Kingdom is mistaken. Moreover, during times of peace, the elves hold supreme authority, as they are known as the most

peace-loving race in this world.”

“But when war is on the horizon,” he continued, his tone taking on a more serious note, “the vampires take the lead and assume complete control over both councils. The matriarch of the vampires holds the highest position, hailing from the noblest of vampire royal dynasties.”

“The matriarch of elves also hails from the noblest of elven dynasties, the Lady of Flowers, Lady Elfine Do ‘elf Elfona,” she replied, her voice filled with reverence, as if the mere mention of the name could bring prosperity to the entire realm. “In times of war, you should indeed turn to the vampires, as they possess unmatched strength and power. However, during the day, when the sun shines, we still need the elves to fight alongside us. Their affinity for peace is essential to balance the power dynamics. But as night falls, the vampires shall reign superior, for we are the strongest species of them all.”

His words painted a vivid picture of the intricate dance between the elves and vampires, their roles intertwined in the delicate balance of power as lord Koss said with pride in his eyes.

“Are you forgetting the grand liches?” reminded the elf, her voice tinged with an air of superiority.

“They went extinct due to the joint effort of our kingdom and the dictatorship,” said the vampire, acknowledging the truth.

The elf smiled, feeling triumphant. “The very dictatorship that wants us extinct. They are behind this demon issue. They must be using the bodies of grand liches and arch liches, using them as catalysts to drain mana from humans.”

The vampire tried to maintain his composure. “I won’t

deny that possibility, but it took 1000 arch liches together to bring down our last king. And his daughter, the strongest of the royal vampires, remains a force to be reckoned with.”

The elf, finally sounding defeated said “Don’t forget about her husband.”

Lord Koss’s voice resonated with a touch of reverence as he uttered the words that echoed through the ages, “Well, of course, no one can forget her husband, the mightiest being in the entire universe, and the sole benefactor of this kingdom. But do not, I repeat, do not forget that he transcended into something greater a being beyond mortal limits. The legendary First Hero, a figure of unparalleled grandeur, turned himself into a royal vampire.”

As the words hung in the air, the atmosphere seemed to shift, as if paying homage to the immortal legend. The mention of the First Hero, a revered and celestial figure, sent shivers down the elf’s spine, and she appeared to be finally defeated. For in the heart of every inhabitant of this kingdom, the First Hero was not just a hero but a divine embodiment of power and wisdom—a figure whose very existence shaped the destiny of this realm or so I understood from the bits of information I got from both elf and the hound.

“If I heard correctly, vampires are immortal beings, so the First Hero must still be among us,” I asked eagerly, the prospect of meeting such a legendary figure filling me with excitement.

“You heard right but,” replied the vampire with a hint of sorrow in his tone. “The First Hero was a summoned agent of the gods, much like you. But he was not merely

reincarnated here once; he was brought to this world twice, destined to shape its very destiny. He is also the progenitor of the Index of Magic. Upon completing his sacred mission, he was sent back to wherever he came from, and we eagerly await his third return.”

The melancholic tone in the vampire's voice hinted at a profound longing, as if the only thing that pained him was the distance that kept him from the presence of the revered First Hero.

In a sudden shift of atmosphere, Lord Koss turned his attention to the wall, lost in thought for an unspecified period. As he turned back to face me, his tone carried an air of determination. “We shall take you to the Joint Council,” the vampire declared, his words resonating with authority.

I couldn't help but wonder how this though had reached me while fighting over politics. The director, now visibly concerned about the breach, questioned, “Isn't this cell warded against transmission magic and all other forms of sorcery? Pray tell how did you got a message down here lord Koss.”

Smirking with confidence, Lord Koss responded, “The transmission came from none other than the Sorceress of Annihilation. Mere magic warding crystals hold no power against her. She can bend the very fabric of reality with her enchantments.”

The director, conceding to the Sorceress's prowess, left the cell, perhaps to attend to matters beyond.

“Now, my bloodbag,” Lord Koss addressed me with a hint of amusement, “it seems it's time for you to meet the esteemed Joint Council.”

Suddenly I was engulfed with darkness.

11. The Enigmatic Gathering

As the darkness slowly subsided, I found myself standing in yet another dimly lit chamber, but this room held a peculiar and enchanting allure. Bathed in an ethereal blue tint, everything from the grand pillars to the castle-like walls seemed to exude an otherworldly essence. Yet, as I glanced up, I realized that the true source of this enchanting hue was the resplendent chandelier suspended from the high ceiling.

The chandelier was unlike any I had ever seen before, reminiscent of something straight out of a fantastical tale. Its intricate design featured elaborate patterns and delicate carvings it had blue flame burning on it which were the reason of the ethereal blue tint.

As I began to notice the features around, I wondered why I was alone in this room. Just moments ago, I had been a prisoner. Did they suddenly gain trust in me, or was this place truly inescapable? The possibility of escape lingered in my mind, but before I could explore it further, the room began to shake violently, as if struck by an earthquake. The unsettling sensation reminded me of the reality plane I had encountered before meeting the god.

Amidst the tremors, I heard a peculiar noise, mechanical and rhythmic, like the turning of gears. My curiosity piqued, I followed the sound and found myself facing a round table. The table exuded an air of importance and was adorned with intricate details, reminiscent of the legendary Arthurian round table.

I was sure there was no table at the centre before I

heard the noise but before I could investigate further, a sudden wave of fear washed over me, causing my knees to buckle beneath me. I crashed to the ground, my nose stinging from the impact. It was a familiar feeling, one I had experienced before, triggered by the memory of a past encounter that still haunted me.

Despite my attempts to fight it, my heart raced, and my body refused to obey my rational thoughts. It was as if my primal instincts were taking control, urging me to surrender to the overpowering fear.

A familiar voice which sounded annoyed questioned my worthiness, "If you are this weak, why did the Almighty even choose you?" As I looked up, I saw the gorgeous woman I had met just before my hound companion's demise. Attempting to impress her, I replied, "God chose me because He saw my willpower," although deep inside, I knew she was leagues above me.

Suddenly, my vision changed once more, similar to the event at the lake's shore. It had not occurred since then, leaving me astonished. I gazed at my hand, still radiating a blue aura, but when I looked at the lady before me, her aura appeared even deeper crimson than the hound's, whom I had considered a psychopath. Realizing that hers must be at least double that, I could not help but feel a mix fear and awe.

"Oh, you do have the eye of judgment, don't you," said another voice, but it held an uncanny quality. It seemed to resonate in a frequency beyond the natural, yet I could hear her with eerie clarity. The nature of power exuded from her words, sending shivers down my spine. I dreaded meeting the speaker, but fate had different plans as she emerged from the darkness. Her skin was as pale as snow,

and her eyes bore a striking combination of colours—black for the sclera and a dark, ruby-red for the iris. The crimson hue was deeper than any shade I had ever seen, yet it shined with an unsettling brilliance. As my gaze fixated on her, I could not sense her aura, but her features were starkly apparent. The moment her eyes laid on my mortal body, I noticed a black aura radiating from her, sending chills down my spine. Despite her terrifying aura and striking eyes, her clothes were surprisingly ordinary. She looked like a teenager, dressed in a simple ensemble—a black pair of jeans and a black t-shirt. Her appearance contradicted the immense power she exuded. With a rather robust body, she seemed unassuming in her attire, but there was an undeniable air of authority about her that left me unsettled. The contrast between her youthful appearance and the overwhelming presence she emanated made her all the more enigmatic and intimidating.

“Do not bully the chosen agent of God, for we might face punishment on the day of our final judgment,” said a voice that resonated with beauty and perfection. As the third figure emerged into the blue light, I immediately recognized her—it was the prison director. Confusion filled my mind as I wondered why she was here. “Please tell me this is still a prison, and I am sure you don’t allow visitors to kill prisoners, do you?” I pleaded, still lying on the ground, my knees refusing to obey any command.

“Oh, darling, I think you’ve confused me for my younger sister. But do not worry, no one will dare touch you in my presence,” said the person who claimed to be the elder sister of the prison director. I felt a mixture of relief and trepidation in her presence, my eyes saw that

her aura had a tint of green I felt relieved as I knew nothing bad can come from the colour of nature. "Please save me," I implored, hoping that she could indeed offer some assistance dumb as it sounded, I felt she was the only person I could trust in this room right now.

Immediately, the air pressure surged, and her body was surrounded by a vibrant green light, illuminating the entire room with an otherworldly glow. It was evident that she possessed an incredible strength. "I ask the Witch of Annihilation to put down the barrier she placed, which is making Sir Hero unable to stand on his knees. For whatever authority you vampires hold during war, the war is yet to begin," she declared with a firmness that commanded respect.

"All right, Queen, I'm sorry," said the brown-haired person, her tone heavy with sarcasm, as she clicked her fingers. Instantly, my knees found strength, and with the elf's assistance, I rose slowly. "Sir hero, you have the backing of 1 million elves, so no need to worry," she whispered gently in my ear.

"So, Your Majesty, the great Elfona, do your divine eyes reveal his origin, or are they a mere ruse to deceive vampires?" questioned the lady in jeans, dripping with sarcasm. "I am well aware they work, sensing his mana surpasses that of a human. My queen, doubting his hero status would be foolish. Let's ask him why he's here and if he is a foe to the kingdom or an ally." her voice made it clear that she wanted me to be a foe for the kingdom said the witch of Annihilation with humbleness

"Sir Hero, we are considered the three strongest in this kingdom. I am Elfona, the Queen of Elves," she introduced herself, gesturing towards the woman beside

her. “This is Liza Nightshade, the Director of both the School of Mages and the Mage Guild, bearing the legendary title of Witch of Annihilation.” As soon as Liza was acknowledged, I witnessed her encircled by ethereal magical constructs of various shapes, captivatingly rotating around her. She surely knew how to make a dramatic entrance.

“And this,” Elfona continued, pointing to the girl in the black shirt and jeans, “is Sybilla von Nyx Hecate Darkcrest the matriarch of Vampires and also the wife of the first hero bearing the legendary title of Night’s Sovereign,” the elves chimed in, affirming her grand status. However, Sybilla immediately interjected, “Please call me Hecate, unless we are in front of the whole council, then you may address me as Majesty or Count Sybilla.” Her voice was no longer the strange, magical tone she used before but rather a cute and pleasant one. I quickly reminded myself not to entertain any inappropriate thoughts, considering vampires’ mind-reading abilities.

12. Catalyst Of The Kingdom

As I pondered my opinion of these three remarkable women, they each took their predetermined seats, leaving one spot unoccupied. "Now, let us discuss the matter at hand between the two of you before we decide the fate of Sir Hero," asserted Elfona with an air of authority.

"It appears the pressing matter is the Regenspire's hound meeting its demise in our kingdom," offered Hecate, her voice filled with conviction.

Liza, sounding like the strategist, chimed in, "Indeed, we could claim the hound invaded, but alas, we lack concrete evidence. We dare not rely on Lord Koss, for his revelation of betraying the hound's party as a double agent would cast doubt upon his loyalty and furthermore, he is the only source of information we got inside hound right now and you know how much illegal trade we let happen to get that."

The burden of dictatorship did not concern her. She looked over-confident, Elfona continued, "The suppressive tactics they might employ will not deter us. They dare not let this mess surface, as it would unveil their inhumane experiments, thereby forfeiting support from the holy kingdom."

Together, they weighed the ramifications of their actions.

As I observed the situation, relief washed over me knowing that it would not escalate into an all-out war, sparing countless lives from needless tragedy. Yet, the gravity of the matter could not be overlooked, and I knew

it would not be taken lightly.

“I believe the origin of this plan lies not with the hound, but rather with his captain, who instigated the entire scheme,” I ventured, hoping to contribute meaningfully and make a favourable impression. Suddenly, Liza rose from her seat, offering her support. “Did the hound explicitly state this?” she inquired, her eyes glimmering with hope. “Yes, he made it quite clear,” I replied with pride, hoping to impress the formidable Witch of Annihilation.

Elfona interjected, “Then we have yet another pressing matter at hand. The captain of the hound unit is likely closing in to avenge the loss of their fallen comrade.” Her words hung heavily in the air. “Though such an act won’t garner official support from the dictatorship or so they would say if this ever comes out, but it is highly probable that the entire hound unit is headed our way.”

“We find ourselves at a disadvantage, for while we are formidable, this battle might elude our grasp with only 50 half-elf soldiers at our disposal,” Hecate lamented, her tone tinged with sadness. My quest for hope led me to interject, “But I thought you three were the strongest among all!”

Liza gently revealed the truth, “True, individually, we possess great power, but our hands are bound by multiple restrictions. Elfona, as the holy queen, cannot engage in combat, lest it triggers an all-out war from the elf’s side. For myself, a confrontation risks war with the holy empire, given my position as the director of the mage guild and mage school - striving to maintain neutrality. As for Hecate, unlike us her hand is laden with more problems if she were to fight the war will begin from both

ends holy kingdom and the dictatorship together.”

“Why can’t you, Hecate, find a way to fight despite the politics?” I inquired, seeking a solution to her predicament. Her response was unequivocal, “My mana is boundless and holy empire have built something called sensors which detect this and alarm them, and attempting to restrain it would be futile once I activate my title for an all-out battle and without mana I am as strong as you are and you know how that fares our Infront of hounds, immediately breaking the three kingdom treaty article 4.”

As I wrestled with my limited knowledge of their world, I grappled with the complexity of the situation, trying to conceive a plan that would not ignite war on any front. However, the intricacies of their challenges seemed insurmountable.

“I have a solution,” declared Elfona, her voice brimming with both determination and delight. Hecate, though not visibly pleased, could not hide the sparkle in her eyes as she inquired, “What might that be?”

“Liza, being the most skilled mage among us, can utilize her expertise to activate the advanced stage index of magic of our Sir hero. With this newfound power, Sir Hero can fight for our cause as the righteous hero he is,” Elfona proposed, her gaze shifting towards me with a hint of remorse, acknowledging that I might feel coerced into siding with them. However, my loyalty was unwavering even before I suicided thus, I declared boldly, “I will always support you all.”

The plan seemed flawless, as Hecate envisioned, “This approach could work exceedingly well. If Sir Hero were to betray us, it would offer me the opportunity to unleash my limitless mana and potentially obliterate both him and

the dictatorship in a single decisive move.”

The room buzzed with a sense of hope and unity as the women embraced their roles in the intricate web of fate that lay ahead. I, too, felt a surge of purpose, ready to stand alongside them in this precarious endeavour, guided by their wisdom and courage.

“Then I must take him to the temple, but does he have the catalyst, or will the nation provide him one?” asked Liza.

“What does a catalyst mean in this context? Do I need H₂SO₄?” I asked with a touch of sarcasm.

“Catalyst, in this case, refers to anything you have gained from your exploits or the exploits of your predecessors as you are one of the gods agents. It will be sacrificed to the system, combined with your life force and an instigator’s mana, granting you the advanced index of magic,” Liza explained, highlighting her adept teaching skills.

“Before we head to the temple, could you please explain to me what the system entails and why sacrifice holds such significance in this world?” I asked Liza, using my most pleading puppy eyes, knowing she could not resist them.

Liza began to unravel the profound workings of their world, “When the divine beings created this world, they established a balanced system with one fundamental rule: to maintain equilibrium at all times. So, if one desires something significant, like riches, they must offer something of equal value in return. The balance then grants their request, and this fundamental principle governs how this world functions. Taking advantage of this system, Lord First sacrificed the lifeforce of nine

hundred million lives to request the creation of the 'index of magic.' This system has two stages devised by him."

"The first stage grants the person the ability to reveal their own mana reserve and health to others. You might even be able to perceive it slightly if you concentrate and squint your eyes," Liza explained.

"The second stage, however, is more remarkable. It endows the individual with the ability to perceive the mana and health of anyone with mana. Moreover, they can attain titles and levels if they are proficient in the process. Titles are granted by the index of magic when someone achieves something nearly impossible. Once acquired, these titles can be kept hidden or revealed, each providing unique buffs. For example, when revealed my title, 'Witch of Annihilation,' grants me the blessings of boundless mana and 500 times enhanced destructive power this is also the application of the equilibrium I give them important information like what my capability are which can be disadvantageous for me but this title makes me stronger the more information I give so is the fundamental work of title. As for levels, Lord First relinquished his boundless capabilities to embrace limitations in the form of a level cap. Each level gained makes him a hundred times stronger, we further copied his example and gave away all our boundlessness to be stronger with a level cap and all three of us here are at the level cap and most of the citizen of our nation have activated the advance index of magic " she clarified.

Liza's exceptional teaching skills left me in awe, realizing why she was the revered director of a prestigious school. Her ability to convey complex information with clarity and her insights into what I wanted to know were

truly awe-inspiring.

“Can we get started on this process right away?” I eagerly inquired, determined to become as formidable as them and curious about the title I might gain. Elfona responded, sharing my enthusiasm, “As soon as we find a suitable catalyst for you.”

Suddenly, inspiration struck, and I remembered an extraordinary feat from my journey to this realm. “Wait, I have something in mind,” I exclaimed. Reaching into my pocket, I retrieved a dragon’s claw, a trophy from when I had slain a dragon during my descent into this world. Holding it up, I asked, “Will this be sufficient as a catalyst?”

The air in the room seemed to hold its breath as the others examined the dragon’s claw. Elfona and Hecate exchanged glances, contemplating its potential as the catalyst I needed “Liza I think this will work” said Hecate showing it to Liza and I saw a visible concern in everyone’s face there they looked almost scared.

13. The Unseen Path

As I stood there, awaiting the trio's next move, Liza approached me and gently clasped my hand. "Now, hold on tightly, my dear," she said, her smile radiating warmth. However, in an instant, her smile vanished, and so did she, along with the entire world around me. Darkness enveloped me, leaving me in a state of utter disarray for what felt like an eternity. The minutes passed slowly, like an eternal void, until suddenly, the world materialized once again.

The transition was abrupt as I found myself inside the what looked like Cathedral, a sense of awe overwhelmed me. The vast expanse of the sacred hall was adorned with intricate carvings, sparkling stained glass windows, and grand pillars reaching for the heavens. The air felt charged with ancient magic, and the soft glow of mystical runes cast ethereal patterns on the marble floor everything had emphasis on the word grand.

As I looked around, I heard a gentle sound, and suddenly, Liza was there before me. Intrigued by her teleportation ability, I couldn't help but ask, "How do you manage to teleport like this? It's an incredibly powerful skill to have."

Liza smiled gently as she explained, "There are two methods of teleportation. The first method involves using teleportation marks within a room. By synchronizing those marks with the corresponding frequency in another location, the data is transferred, allowing the body to be disassembled and reassembled at the destination."

“The second method, which I used to free you from prison, is more personal,” she continued. “It involves synchronizing your frequencies with mine, pulling you out of that specific space and time, and then aligning you with my own frequency.”

Her explanation fascinated me, revealing the intricacies of mage craft. Then she asked, “does mage craft interest you”, I confessed, “I didn’t have magic in my world.”

“Magic is just like any other power. While magic may be common here, good-willed humans aren’t, and not all demi-humans possess benevolence either. Mana is akin to energy; you had something called nuclear energy in your world, right? It could have been used for betterment, but you know how that worked,” Liza said with a touch of melancholy in her voice, as if she could personally relate to the consequences.

Curiosity prompted me to inquire, “But how do you know about my world?”

She blushed slightly before revealing, “Lord First was my teacher, and he often compared me to a hydrogen bomb when scolding me. He had extensive vocabulary for scolding.”

This revelation deepened my curiosity about Lord First’s identity. “How did you know that I belong to that particular Earth where your lord first came from?” I asked, remembering that God himself said that the existence of a multiverse is the actual truth.

“Do you know how these multiple universes exist together? You might think there is a place outside the multiverse and that it would be stretched out like galaxies, but that’s not right,” Liza explained.

Curious, I asked, "Then what is right, Liza?"

"The multiple universes or the multiverse are vibrating at different frequencies, which keeps them apart. What God did was create spaces within these frequency gaps and use them as bridges and more for his own entertainment. Do you know how we are being kept in this universe right now?" she inquired.

"I guess by matching my frequency to something in here," I replied, trying to figure out the connection.

Liza clarified, "Your frequency was matched with the 'bridge,' which is actually supposed to be the only non-changing thing in creation. It is designed so that divines can match their frequency with our universe."

Then, she blinked at me, and suddenly, it dawned on me. "That's exactly like teleportation! So, were you able to see where my frequency was synced with, guessing my origin?" I asked, realizing she might have discovered my identity through this process.

"Of course not. It was your accent that made it obvious you hailed from the same place as Lord First, you idiot. But what I was getting at was the fact that your original frequency was etched into the bridge. This will allow you to return to your world, and Elfona saw these etching, confirming that you are from Lord's world," she said, laughing at my cluelessness.

Embarrassed yet amused, I blushed. Talking to a female after so long was an unexpected and intriguing experience.

"Wait, did you just say accent?" I asked Liza, seeking confirmation.

"Yes, your accent and way of speaking, along with certain words like 'frequency,' all of them match Lord

First's accent," she replied, unaware of the significance of her observation.

"If our accents match, he must be from my country!" I exclaimed loudly, a surge of excitement rushing through me. Her eyes widened, and the red iris revealed the full extent of her beauty.

In a rush, Liza said, "When you say, 'same country,' is it possible you had someone like... wait, follow me!" With urgency, she darted towards a dark corridor inside the grand cathedral. I followed, matching her pace, as we moved towards the heart of the sacred place. Suddenly, she came to a halt, but in my haste, I accidentally bumped into her soft, pillow-like body. Her hair emitted a pleasant scent, further distracting me.

"Well, look up," she said, realizing it was too dark to see anything. In a swift motion, she clapped her hands, and the room lit up. Before me, I saw a face that left me awestruck.

A white marble construct of a man stood before me, with sharp features, a pronounced jawline, and a handsome face. Though I couldn't be certain if he was from my original country, I believed that with a colour photo or some additional evidence, I might be able to ascertain the truth.

"I know it's larger than life, but right now, this is the only thing we have," Liza said, sensing my disappointment.

"Don't worry about that. I'm sure they didn't have cameras back then," I reassured Liza, understanding the depth of her emotions and the nostalgia she felt for her master.

In that moment, I realized the connection between Liza

and Lord First, the teacher she cherished deeply. The bond they shared transcended time and space, and I couldn't help but feel a profound sense of respect and admiration for their relationship, and sadness for their undue separation.

"We have no time to waste," said Liza, her demeanour now focused and determined. "Follow me." She grabbed my arm, and I obediently followed her. To my astonishment, she led me behind the statue, where a secret gateway lay hidden. It was as if the statue itself was a concealed entrance. We entered through the gate, and I found myself in a secret altar room. At its centre stood a marble statue of a hooded figure a statue I hoped, surrounded by a pool of water as clear as the sky.

"Go inside the water," Liza instructed, pushing me gently towards it. "I will ask you to repeat the words I say, and remember, if you mess up, it might even be fatal."

As I stepped into the water, inching forward towards the creepy statue I braced myself for whatever lay ahead. The gravity of the situation was apparent, and I knew I had to focus entirely on following Liza's instructions with precision and care.

"But then again, my mind was all about second-guessing it," I thought to myself. Before proceeding, Liza humorously reminded me, "Before that, I almost forgot to ask your name." With a smile, I replied, "It's Jonnathan, but please call me Jerry."

"Okay, Jerry, get ready for your enlightenment, remember to hold the catalyst up in the air" Liza said, bending down to touch the water. As her hand made contact, the water began to glow intensely, emitting a white light. With a commanding tone, Liza instructed me,

“Repeat with me now.”

“I, Jonnathan ‘Jerry,’ want to sacrifice my boundless potential, a portion of my life force, the instigator’s mana filling the pool, and this catalyst. I also seek the aid of the first hero’s sacrifice of 900 million to help me gain entry into the index of magic,” Liza recited.

“I, Jonnathan ‘Jerry,’ want to sacrifice my boundless potential, a portion of my life force, the instigator’s mana filling the pool, and this catalyst. I also seek the aid of the first hero’s sacrifice of 900 million to help me gain entry into the index of magic,” I echoed her words. As I did, my body began to glow as brilliantly as the pool I was immersed in. The aura surrounding me grew more radiant, I felt my body itself burning. My knees gave away and my eyes couldn’t open I found myself yet again in darkness.

14. Inert Awakening

As I regained consciousness, I found myself once again in the white expanse of nothingness where my adventure had begun. The same voice that initiated this journey resonated within and around me, asking, "So, it seems you have successfully reached a place that supports your political and social ideals, does it?"

"I believe so," I replied, trying to sound less confrontational and more genuinely puzzled, as the last thing I wanted was to be instantly evaporated.

"I see," the god responded, his tone filled with understanding. "As the catalyst of this quest, I am glad to witness that you have rekindled your will to live."

His words struck a chord within me, and I began to contemplate the reason behind my past decision. "Will to live," I repeated, finding the phrase foreign to my tongue. It was then that I realized the true motivation behind my previous actions. It wasn't that I despised life or lacked a desire to live. Instead, it was the feeling of being trapped, unable to amend my mistakes or change the opinions of those around me. My only escape was to indulge in this escapist fantasy, a way to find happiness and solace in a world of my own making. That's why I had resorted to such drastic measures in the past, that's why I went to the cell tower, I pondered.

"Oh, before you delve too deeply into the memory lane and ponder the reasons for your demise, please understand that my time is limited. I have universes to create and destroy," the god interjected with a sense of

humility, though I sensed a genuine fondness in his words. It was the first time someone seemed to appreciate my company, even if it was merely a facade of benevolence.

“Let me get straight to the point,” he continued. “As a reward for getting a Kingdom to support and sponsor you, I shall grant you the power to summon one of the three people you desired to bring to this world as of our deal.” His voice brimmed with pride as he bestowed the offer upon me.

The magnitude of the gift left me speechless. I could now reunite with Charlie or perhaps invite her to this captivating realm. Yet, before I could even contemplate who to summon, I succumbed to unconsciousness once more.

As I regained consciousness, I found myself no longer in the presence of the god. Instead, Liza stood before me, her expression filled with worry. “Jerry, what took you so long?” she inquired anxiously, but before I could respond, my vision shifted once again. Just as before, I saw Liza surrounded by her red aura, and the familiar health and mana bars. However, this time, a new addition appeared – a green bar revolving around her head, indicating her perfect health, and a yellow bar revolving around her torso, indicating her full mana. Additionally, a notification-like window appeared before my eyes, much like the ones you receive on your phone for messages. It read ‘WITCH OF ANNIHILATION,’ indicating that she was maintaining her title at the time.

“I can clearly see your health, mana, and title, but where is my level bar? If this is like a game, then my level bar should be displayed right in the corner,” I asked Liza with genuine curiosity, trying to make sense of the

situation.

Liza smiled, "For the first time, I could see determination in your eyes. It's a nice look to have. Earlier, you looked as dead as a fish out of water, and that disgusted me. Also, if you are looking for your level, just think of 'level' in your mind, and you will receive a notification. Sir First called it 'The Index,' and it will display your level."

Intrigued, I followed Liza's advice. First, I activated the Index of Magic, and then I focused on my own level. Suddenly, a window appeared before me, glowing with an outline of yellow with a black interior, similar to the previous notifications. It displayed 'Level – 100' on the top line and 'Titles: Dragon Slayer, God's Agent' on the second line, both illuminated in blue. As I read the last line, I was completely dumbfounded – 'Species – Divine Being.' I realized that from the very beginning, my level was an astonishing 100, and I wasn't a human, but a divine being.

Feeling curious, I decided to put my newly discovered title to the test. "Activate title: Dragon Slayer," I said aloud, and to my surprise, the system promptly heeded my command.

As I regained my touch of reality once more, I realized that the system had taken the dragon's claw from my hand to use as a catalyst. "So, you have the title of dragon slayer. Well, it's an uncommon one for sure, but what enhancements does it provide?" asked a curious Liza.

"How do I check for that?" I asked, feeling embarrassed by my lack of knowledge.

"Reactivate your index and think about titles. And please, if you want to activate another title, do it quietly.

The purpose of titles is to surprise your opponent's when the power comes into effect, not to announce it beforehand and give them a chance to dice you into pieces," she explained, her tone respectful yet firm, much like how she treated her students.

"Alright," I said, taking her advice seriously. I activated my index once again and focused on the titles. The same window appeared, this time with a small paragraph written about the title.

"Title: Dragon Slayer,

Rarity: Uncommon,

Conditions: Slaying a level 200 dragon,

Enhancements: Amplifications of one's innate strength by 10 times, invoking fear in lesser mana imbued beings, faster regeneration," I read aloud for Liza to hear and judge.

"Not bad for a rookie," she winked, and I couldn't help but feel a sense of pride. "Well, I am level 100, so don't call me a rookie," I said, trying to flex my level with a hint of humor.

As Liza laughed loudly, her voice echoing through the entire hall, she asked me, "Wait, what do you think my level is?" Still feeling a bit embarrassed, I replied, "Maybe 100 as well."

She couldn't hold her laughter and continued, "Babe, mine is 1,000,000. The level cap for divine beings is at 100,000,000. Even elven babies are at level 120 at least. But you may be strong for humans; they go up to level 120 and stop."

Realizing my mistake, I felt a mixture of awe and embarrassment. Liza, the great witch, had a level far beyond my comprehension. I decided to learn more about

leveling up from her. "So, how do I level up?" I asked politely.

"It's easy," she explained, regaining her composure. "You can either give the souls of the enemies you've beaten to the system or gradually feed your mana to it every day. The first method will level you up faster, but the second one works too. The best way, though, is to use magic. You can sacrifice your exhaustion for levels, and that's how Sir First laid it out smartly."

Her words intrigued me, as I realized that even with a system in place, magic remained the key to gaining strength in this world. "Liza, will the Witch of Annihilation teach me magic?" I asked politely. But before she could answer, we heard loud screams from outside.

"They are attacking!" Liza exclaimed, rushing out of the door. I followed her, my heart pounding with a mix of fear and excitement.

15. Dance Of Life?

As Liza and I hurriedly rushed out of the heart of the cathedral, we spotted a few people running deep into the corridors, whom I had yet to see before. “Listen, Jerry, I cannot fight them, and I’m not sure you can take them down without magic. So, before you rush into battle, I’ll give you a brief understanding of magic,” Liza said, trying to keep up with her words as she ran as quickly as her magnificent dress allowed.

“Magic has two aspects: speed and potency,” she explained, looking at me as if that alone should be enough to grasp the entire concept. However, I must have appeared more dumbfounded than I thought, as we reached the main gate of the cathedral, and she rolled her eyes before continuing.

“Imagine you want a heat source. What are your options? You can have a fire, right? Or perhaps change the temperature. With magic, you can use mana to rapidly and efficiently move and shake every particle around you, but it drains mana in the long run. Another option is to use hydrogen from the various gases present around you or even from water, using mana to burn it and create a long-lasting heat source with just an upfront usage of mana. Lastly, you can fuse hydrogen atoms together, just like in the sun, which is highly efficient but requires a lot of mana. Just like that, magic is all about finding what the situation requires and what you have in your arsenal. The rest is basic chemistry and physics, which I’m sure you must be good at,” Liza explained, giving me a simplified

understanding of the complex magic, they used in this world.

“Last but not least, I can at least offer you this,” said the Witch of Annihilation. Suddenly, magical shapes appeared all around her, much like the first time I had met her when she was using her magic. In an instant, my body felt a surge of warmth, and a tingling sensation spread across my abdomen.

“I have infused some natural mana into your skin, which will strengthen your tissues,” she explained. “I wish I could do more, but my hands are tied as of my position.” The sorrow in her expression was genuine, and it touched me deeply. In my original world, people had often taken me for granted, and I had grown accustomed to recognizing disingenuous behaviour. However, the Witch of Annihilation was different; she was as sincere as she could be, even feeling sorrow for my fate, despite the fact that it was my own actions that had led to this war in her kingdom.

With newfound confidence, I assured her, “Don’t worry, I am a Hero.” With those words, I boldly opened the gates of the cathedral, ready to face the chaos.

As I ventured beyond the protective shade of the strongest witch, my confidence waned. The air was filled with agonizing shrieks, but it seemed the invaders hadn’t reached the cathedral. Scanning my surroundings, I realized I was close to the center of the walled city. With bravery in my heart, I applied pressure to the ground, propelling myself forward as fast as I could. The friction of 0.9 building up on my sneakers – a foolish choice of footwear for a battle – reminded me of my hasty rush to confront the war, clad in just a t-shirt, jeans, and sneakers,

akin to a true hero, or so I imagined.

Amid my sprint, I encountered many civilians seeking refuge within their own city. Despite their desperate pleas for help, I couldn't afford to halt; stopping would create an endless cycle of assistance, leaving more people in similar dire circumstances. The weight of their suffering clouded my thoughts as I reached the city wall, where I witnessed black-dressed humans with green hair fighting individuals who bore an eerie resemblance to the hound I had met earlier. "This is for Ksir," one of the fighters declared as they tore apart the black-dressed humans, they were clearly the invaders so these green hair people must be the half-elves I figured.

Determined to aid them, I charged towards the half-elves. However, my progress was impeded by two hounds, effectively halting me in my tracks.

Suddenly, the one on my left, who had blond hair for some reason, emitted the unmistakable scent of a real dog, sniffing air around. "You smell like a human. Are you the slave that Ksir was about to trade?" he loudly inquired, causing some of his comrades to pause upon hearing the fallen one's name. "Come with us," said the person on my right, who had red hair. "Together, we will bring down this kingdom. It disgusts me that it even exists in the first place – a place filled with good-for-nothing people," the person on the left declared, revealing his disdain, which he believed to be a good idea. However, his words felt like a gut punch to me.

"These good-for-nothing people saved me from being a slave," I responded, my anger simmering within. Typically, I avoided getting angry, often playing the role of a peacemaker to dissuade others from engaging in

confrontations with troublemakers. But not today. The emotions surged, and without hesitation, I let my fury speak for itself. In an instant, I threw a powerful punch, connecting it with the face of the person who had disgusted me with his words.

As my punch connected, it created a visible shockwave of air that rippled through the surroundings. The person I struck was sent flying backward, and the others looked on in shock before retaliating. Realizing my own recklessness, I wasn't prepared to stop being impulsive just yet. I crouched down and jumped as if attempting a high jump, only to find myself soaring easily for at least 20 meters midair. The severity of the situation became evident as I gained altitude, observing more hounds approaching the city like a relentless swarm of ants.

In a swift decision, I knew how to halt my momentum and landed on a hound, utilizing the pressure of his falling body to break his bones upon impact. With a bunny jump, I quickly transitioned to another hound, twisting its neck before regaining my stance. "So, who else wants to meet their end?" I asked with a grim smile, eager to explore the limits of my newfound strength.

I soon realized that these clichés didn't work in real life, as the adversaries I challenged stepped forward, each revealing their unique and deadly gifts. One had a katana for a wrist, another had nails as long as a katana, while another sported a gun for a wrist. There were several others whose transformations I missed as I witnessed a bullet hurtling towards me with a blistering speed of 1,422 m/s. from that fleeting moment, the physical limitations of humans was forgotten, as I felt an overwhelming surge

of power. With adrenaline coursing through my veins, I reacted swiftly, plucking the bullet out of mid-air with the prowess of a seasoned superhero.

Without hesitation, I leaped towards a group of well-armed militants, lacking any weapon in my hand. Amidst the chaos, I realized the extent of my impetuosity. My actions seemed to be driven by an uncontrollable force as I approached the one with a katana for a hand. My speed was beyond anything my body had ever experienced before. With a savage ferocity, I shattered his arm, ripping off the bones to fashion my own makeshift katana.

“Come, let the dance of life and death begin,” I bellowed, facing off against groups of two with complementary abilities. It didn’t matter how well their abilities aligned; it was inconsequential before my newfound might. In a blink of an eye, I eliminated almost everyone standing in front of me, leaving just two hounds with gun-type abilities. As I faced them, I sensed a mounting danger. Without warning, 100 different types of bullets were hurtling towards me with the intent to obliterate me with a single strike. All I had was one sword.

16. Newcomer

“Not just any sword,” echoed a voice in my mind, and I suddenly realized that I wasn’t carrying an ordinary weapon. It was like a katana, with its distinct curved blade. A realization dawned upon me – katanas were known to cut through bullets. And even if they couldn’t, I was swift enough to evade them all. Standing strong and resolute, I prepared to cut all the bullets in half as soon as they reached my striking zone. In the blink of an eye, all the ammunition they had was finished, and I began to close the distance between us. However, they were no fools; seeing the lifeless bodies of their comrades, they knew that I meant to kill them too. Panic struck, and they started fleeing, but I had had enough of their atrocities.

Taking a deep breath, I focused my mind. It was time to employ a technique they didn’t possess. “If Liza said I can move particles around, I might as well make them still and create a wall,” I whispered to myself, concentrating on the task at hand while running toward them. Suddenly, knowledge flooded my mind, as if the ability to manipulate the world around me had always been there. I understood the x, y, z vectors and the required mana for the task, along with the rate of consumption per minute. It was as if I had been given a map of the universe’s secrets. “I don’t need it for long,” I reassured myself, channelling all my strength into my legs and dashing forward. My rivals took off in a desperate attempt to escape, but they were brought to an abrupt halt by the invisible wall I had created.

Seeing my chance, I closed the distance to my dumbfounded foes. With a swift attack, I sliced through one of them, and with my left hand, I crushed their skull, putting an end to their futile attempts to escape.

As I surveyed the aftermath, I witnessed the carnage that my bloodlust had wrought. The lifeless bodies of those half-elves, who sacrificed themselves due to my own pathetic actions, lay strewn around me. My heart ached with grief as I caught sight of the last surviving hound the criminals, trembling in fear on the ground. “So, you are the sole witness to my butchery acts,” I declared with a mixture of confidence and remorse, the soft rays of dawn illuminating my troubled face.

As the sun broke through the sky, casting a gentle glow on the scene, I approached the weeping hound. He appeared to be around my age, with dark brown hair and striking red irises. Through his tears, he uttered, “Every herd has a shepherd to guide them, every pack has an alpha.” His words seemed somewhat muddled, but I paid them little mind as I moved swiftly towards him, my blade creating a hazy blur in the air. In one swift motion, I brought the blade down, ending his suffering.

As I stood over the fallen hound, a new voice suddenly pierced the silence with a tone of pride. I turned to see a man dressed in a black Sunday suit with matching shoes, approaching confidently from the direction of the rising sun, his shadow elongating as he drew near. He gazed at the bodies of his comrades, his eyes widening with shock and grief. “He was right about the shepherd thing, you know,” he remarked, trying to maintain his composure despite the grisly sight before him.

A sense of grim satisfaction washed over me as I

looked at this man. "I will spare your life, but you must run, coward," I taunted, a sinister smile playing on my lips.

"Let's see who will need to run in just five seconds," the newcomer proclaimed with a hint of amusement, cracking his fingers one by one and snapping his neck in a classic standoff cliché. I was prepared for his attack; I could create an invisible barrier to protect myself. But then, in the blink of an eye, he blurred into a haze and reappeared right in front of me. Thankfully, my makeshift katana allowed me to intercept his deadly punch, preventing my untimely demise but broke my katana. He vanished again, moving with an almost teleportation-like speed.

"So, your gift is teleportation?" I shouted, quickly forming a defensive wall around me, hoping to counter his teleporting manoeuvres. But it was futile; he effortlessly teleported behind me, proving that it wasn't teleportation at all. Grabbing my shoulder "Teleportation? That was merely my speed. Oh, too fast for you? Want me to slow down?" he taunted with a condescending voice, clearly enjoying our encounter. Then he disappeared

Frustration boiled within me as he acted smug, treating me like a broken object. My heart raced as I mustered all my mana to confront him head-on. Suddenly, my vision shifted to a system view mode, displaying my health, mana, and allowing me to see him as well. He circled around me like a wolf, calculating his next move. With determination, I etched a wall of particles from the direction he was approaching, but his face remained unchanged. Boredom etched on his sharp chin; he

scrutinized me as if I were a specimen in an experiment. His crimson eyes exuded a sense of uninterested superiority, while his high-held nose gave him an air of arrogance. All of this only fuelled my anger further, and I fortified my mana barrier, ready to make this arrogant brat suffer.

But, once again, he vanished before my eyes, leaving me frustrated and on edge.

I looked behind, certain he was resorting to underhanded tactics to gain the upper hand. But to my surprise, he appeared from the front, casually punching the invisible wall I had conjured. To my horror, the space itself shattered like a broken mirror, creating intricate cracks that rippled through the air. It seemed as if the very fabric of reality was momentarily broken before restoring itself, leaving me astounded by the raw power he possessed.

Before I could recover from this awe-inspiring display, the newcomer swiftly appeared in front of me, disregarding my multiple particle walls. “What are you using your mana for? Stop wasting it,” he taunted, and in an instant, his fist slammed into my gut, sending me hurtling backward. The force of the punch was overwhelming; it shattered everything, even my spine. I crumpled to the ground, darkness closing in on me.

Yet, he was not finished. Approaching me, he stood triumphantly over my fallen form, asserting his dominance.

My vision shifted to a system view, and I could see my health plummet to a mere 20%. With death seemingly imminent, I mustered all the strength I had left and remembered my last resort - the “Judgment of God”

tactic. As I cried out the words, an extraordinary transformation began to take place. The ground trembled, and even the sun's light seemed to fade, as if nature itself acknowledged the gravity of my plea.

Lying on my deathbed, I glimpsed the dead bodies of the hounds and elves stirring, a strange energy animating them. I could feel my mana draining rapidly, but before I could fully comprehend what was happening, the newcomer hound kicked me in the face, expressing irritation at my actions. "What the hell are you doing" he said However, it was too late to stop what was unfolding.

In my vision, the lifeless bodies of the fallen hounds and elves rose to their feet, standing tall with an eerie unity. They stood at attention, as if they were waiting for orders. It was then that I realized - they were my soldiers now, both half-elves and hounds, resurrected and under my command. "Defend me!" I shouted, invoking my newfound authority over these reanimated warriors.

17. Patron

As soon as those words left my mouth, I turned to observe the newcomer's reaction. What I saw was beyond anything I could have imagined. The glint of arrogance he had carried until now was replaced by a level of disgust and fury I had never witnessed. His face turned an alarming shade of red, and his sclera, which was once white, momentarily got infused with crimson, as if blood vessels were about to burst. He lunged at me with a punch, but the shock of my command had slowed him down just enough for me to react. I managed to hold his fist before it landed, buying myself a precious moment.

Meanwhile, the resurrected bodies of my fallen comrades inched forward, bound by my commands, and the sight seemed to infuriate him even more. I did not fully understand what was happening, but it was clear that I was gaining an upper hand against this seemingly superior opponent, and the thrill of it surged through my veins. To witness the high and mighty crumble before me gave me a strange satisfaction.

Despite his anger, he once again disappeared with lightning speed. I braced myself for his inevitable reappearance, but this time, he did something unexpected. He materialized behind me with such velocity that I had no time to react. I thought my life was about to end, but instead, he focused his attack on the dead soldiers I had commanded. With inhuman force, he ripped them apart, reducing their numbers from around twenty to just one in a matter of seconds.

He then grabbed the last remaining functional reanimated soldier of his unit, the one with katana for nails, and threw him at me with a vicious force. The lifeless body knocked me to the ground, and I struggled to regain my bearings. The newcomer's chilling voice echoed in my ears, taunting me. "You stay dead until I finish your ace in the hole, and then I will tear you apart limb by limb."

As he continued his merciless onslaught, the realization of how vast the gap between us in terms of power and speed was dawned on me. It was like facing a supernatural force, a being so terrifyingly fast and strong that he could shatter bones and destroy lives with casual ease. The fear of this super-speedy adversary sent shivers down my spine, and I knew I had to find a way to turn the tables before it was too late.

Then I realized what I had at my disposal - the "Weapon-God" skill, a gift bestowed upon me by the angel. It granted me tremendous strength when wielding a katana. Although my makeshift katana had been broken, I swiftly produced a plan. "I will just make another katana," I whispered, seizing the nail from the dead guy thrown at me. As the newcomer made quick work of the reanimated half-elves, I tore a piece of my own t-shirt and fashioned a makeshift katana.

"I actually shall give you credit; I haven't had this much fun since forever," said the newcomer casually, as he nonchalantly removed the head of a reanimated soldier. "My name is Deputy Captain Nikvlo 'Ripper' Kashikov, second in command of the Hound unit, which you just eradicated. So, tell me, oh brave soldier, what might be your name and who are you associated with?" he inquired.

“I am a Hero summoned to this world by the gods to correct your wrongdoings. If you halt right there and pray, I might ask the god to forgive your sins,” I replied with a sense of superiority, raising my newly created katana in the air.

“Oh, I think you have mistaken me for someone from the Holy Kingdom, and I don’t buy the idea that you’re a hero,” retorted Deputy Captain Nikvlo. Suddenly, he appeared as a hazy figure in the air, and I instinctively took a fighting stance. The angelic boost I received allowed me to keep up with his movements, but I knew it was only possible because of my newfound abilities. It was time to prove my courage and worthiness of these powers.

As he materialized in front of me and launched a punch, I swiftly bent to the side, dodging his attack with agility. Seizing the opportunity, I struck back with my katana, but before my blade could connect, he blurred into a haze and disappeared once again. “You seem to be getting stronger every second, but you can’t defeat me,” taunted the deputy with a smug expression.

“And why is that?” I challenged.

“My gift is that my physical prowess doubles every time I use it. So, every time I use my legs for speed, I am doubling my speed. Right now, I am a living proof of breaking what this kingdom calls physics,” he explained with a smirk.

The repercussions of this knowledge became clear to me. I could not predict his movements as he blurred into a haze, leaving me unable to even perceive his aura in my system viewer mode. Suddenly, he reappeared in front of me at breakneck speed. I could see him, but my reactions

were too slow. His punch connected with my chest, and I was sent flying backward, gasping for breath as I struggled to regain my composure. The fight was far from over, and I needed to find a way to outsmart this formidable adversary.

As my health bar neared 10%, I realized that even though I felt mentally fine due to the skill granted by the angel, my physical condition was far from optimal. However, I refused to back down. Surprisingly, my mana bar still appeared filled to the brim, despite the sudden necromancy I had performed. I had a plan.

As Deputy Captain Nikvlo circled around me like a wolf preparing for his final strike, I taunted him, "Why don't you face someone of your own category? Why hide behind politics to avoid the wrath of the Witch of Annihilation?" My words seemed to momentarily diminish his smug attitude.

"I am not scared of that vampire witch. I am ready to face her right now," he retorted, trying to regain his pride. The trap was set, and I pressed on, suggesting "attack the Mage Association. It was the last thing you had to worry about is losing, and if things went south, you could blame one of the dead soldiers, claiming self-defense during an official investigation."

"Yes, that's a fine idea," he agreed, but then suspicion flickered in his eyes. "Are you trying to provoke me?" he questioned, catching on to my tactics.

"No, I was just curious," I lied, trying to play innocent.

He did not fall for it. "First, I will kill you, and then she will join you in hell," he threatened, turning into a hazy blur as he prepared to strike.

As he approached me, I whispered, "Activate

summoning,” gathering all the mana I had left and using it to create a hole between worlds. I did not have anyone particular from my world in mind; I just sought a powerful ally, someone who could become the protector this kingdom desperately needed. But before the summoning could be completed, something extraordinary happened. As the hound deputy appeared Infront of me about to sucker punch my face

Time itself seemed to slow, just like it had with the other hound. My system viewer activated, and a notification window appeared, the grandest size possible, covering my entire vision. The title “Judgment of God” flashed on the screen, and I focused on the buffs it provided. I was overwhelmed but determined. My mana regeneration was now 100% of current capacity every ten seconds, and I had the ability to control the judgment of gods with a 20% boost to physical strength. Though the second buff confused me, I pushed it aside, knowing that my powers were far beyond the ordinary. I was about to get an ego about it soon I felt.

Yet, I soon realized that time had not actually slowed down; rather, my body had accelerated so rapidly that every moving second now felt like a year. This newfound control was both thrilling and daunting.

“CANCEL SUMMONING!” I shouted, realizing I did not want to waste this precious resource on someone like him when I could take him down myself now with this newfound strength.

Then, I heard a familiar voice, angelic and comforting. My patron angel floated above me, “I have came here through the hole in worlds you created for summoning I was here to see how my brother is working” he said with

a casual tone “really thanks for stopping time do that often” I smiled and said “I can’t stop time for you anymore,” he said, “the bridge is already weak I can’t burden it to carry out my will in this world or my powers will break it remember I am a arch angel and I already saved you 2 times now “ he added

With newfound determination and a sense of responsibility, I faced the formidable deputy, but before my patron’s magic run out, I sucker punched the deputy with all the might I had “cheap” laughed my patron before disappearing I readied myself for facing the deputy ripper one more time with fresh outlook

18. Embers Of Triumph

The end of the time stop left me disoriented, as the effects of the sucker punch reverberated through his senses. The deputy, who had been accustomed to managing situations with unparalleled speed, was taken aback. Even his smug grin could not conceal his astonishment. He swiftly changed his trajectory and vanished into a hazy mist, only to reappear circling around me, resembling the wolf he was.

“Good puppy, now stay away!” I shouted, a moment of boldness flashing across my face. His circling intensified, like a predator stalking its prey. He spoke, voice dripping with a sly edge, “Let’s suppose I take you up on your theory.”

“What theory?” I inquired, but it was already too late. He blurred into view right in front of me, an attack imminent. Swiftly, I dodged his assault, narrowly evading his strike. However, before I could launch a counterattack, he hazed back, leaving me off balance.

“The theory of you being a Hero sent by God,” he stated, returning to his smug demeanour. I readied myself, waiting for him to approach again for another strike. As he circled, the tension between us grew.

“Well, that’s not a theory,” I responded, bracing for his next move. His presence was like a storm, unpredictable and relentless. He continued his verbal assault, his words cutting through the charged air. “The First Hero, renowned as the strongest in the universe, was summoned here because he was the perfect vessel for the chained

Archangel of Destruction. The only one across the multiverse whose hunger for destruction surpassed even that of the angel. The Second Hero's intellect exceeded anyone compatible with the Angel of Wisdom, granting him near-omniscient powers. The Third Hero was brought due to her ability to empathize with and manage humans, her affinity for the Angel of Healing unmatched. And then there is our Fourth, summoned as the perfect vessel for God's right hand, the hand of creation, a direct rival to the First Hero, who channels the left hand of God—the hand of destruction. Against this backdrop, what do you bring to the table?" he taunted, words laced with a cruel truth.

He continued his circling, calculating, waiting for an opening. His speech, though meant to undermine me, had shaken my self-confidence. "That's right, you are pathetic," he proclaimed, his voice resonating with mockery before vanishing once again in his haze of speed.

He reappeared in my field of vision, but I was a fraction too slow in reacting. His hand connected with my arm bone, shattering it instantly on impact, causing me to release a howl of agony. His speed was truly unparalleled, and in his bloodlust, he seemed to forget that I was not just some ordinary soldier. I was the one who had annihilated his entire squadron of soldiers. Fuelled by this realization, I devised a simple yet effective strategy.

Waiting for the opportune moment, I bided my time as he retreated, anticipating my retaliatory strike. With a quick surge of mana, I enveloped myself, deftly manipulating the matter around me using the power of mana. My aim was to disrupt ionic and covalent bonds, mirroring the behaviour of the atmosphere in my own world. I harnessed the surroundings, specifically

collecting hydrogen, to create a protective barrier. I was willing to sacrifice myself if necessary to eliminate this smug adversary once and for all.

But before I could implement this drastic measure, he hazed right in front of me. His punch landed squarely on my chest, sending me hurtling backward. It seemed my hypothesis about hydrogen's potential combustion with friction was incorrect, or rather, he transcended the limitations of friction altogether. My high spirits shattered in the face of this revelation, and I found myself mentally preparing for the inevitable end. It felt as though I was on the brink of death, engulfed in the darkest despair.

However, as the saying goes, it is always darkest before the dawn.

Depleted of mana, I channelled all my energy into wielding my sword with precision and skill, hoping it would be my best defence against the lightning-fast opponent before me. In the midst of our high-speed duel, a spark of inspiration ignited within me. I remembered the unique property of mana, how it could forcibly manipulate the very nature of particles in the surrounding environment.

As he charged toward me with lethal intent, I held my ground, waiting until the last possible moment. Just as he materialized in front of me, his fist aimed to strike, I executed a swift dodge, narrowly avoiding the blow. Seizing the opportunity, I swung my katana with calculated force, aiming to cut through his form. I knew it was a long shot, but this move was never meant to land a hit—it was a strategic manoeuvre to create some distance between us.

True to my expectations, he retreated, his agile figure

resuming its predatory circles around me. I anticipated this pattern and bided my time, waiting for the perfect moment. When he encroached upon the area I had manipulated, where the density of hydrogen particles had been subtly increased, I took advantage of the recently regenerated mana granted by my newly acquired title, “Judgment of God.”

Harnessing the power of the ‘all-penetrating’ mana, I conjured electricity within the manipulated hydrogen field. To my astonishment, my impromptu plan worked flawlessly. A surge of electric energy coursed through the hydrogen-enriched air, and in a spectacular display, a dazzling blaze erupted around the hound deputy. The air crackled with energy, and the flames danced like vengeful spirits, cloaking him in a fierce conflagration.

The sight was both mesmerizing and triumphant, a moment relief flooded my body as I view the aftermath.

The aftermath of our intense battle, made a sense of exhilaration wash over me. It took several seconds for my consciousness to settle, and summoning my courage, I approached the charred remains of the deputy. The sight of his charred body added to my confidence; it seemed that my plan had indeed worked. The area around him, once an old stone road, was now marred by cracks. He lay there, surrounded by his fallen comrades, as if death had shown him mercy. Even in death, there was a serene smile on his face. This smile didn’t appear smug; rather, it seemed to reflect a genuine moment of peace as he reunited with an old colleague — death. They had likely worked together for decades, and now, in his passing, he looked content. This sight reminded me of my own past suicide attempt, when I wasn’t embracing death with

happiness. It made me realize the significance of a fulfilling death. One should depart this world with a sense of satisfaction, not regret. I found myself thankful to the deputy for imparting this valuable lesson.

As I pondered the profound meaning of a meaningful death, my thoughts were interrupted by the presence of an unexpected but intriguing ally. The Witch of Annihilation, Liza, had arrived to meet me. It appeared she had been observing the entirety of our battle from a distance. Her voice carried a mix of appreciation and seriousness as she addressed me, “I must commend your valiant fight. Your efforts won’t go unnoticed. However, what transpired here today cannot be ignored.” Her face held a determined expression, yet her eyes retained their playful glint.

19. Shadows Of Authority

(Charlie's POV)

The world itself appears to me as a labyrinth of dreams, a realm where we chase after our desires with fervour, sometimes even sacrificing everything for their pursuit. Yet, ironically, even after knowing about the labyrinth I find myself ensnared within this very web of dreams. The more I strive to break free, the deeper I seem to sink into its clutches. It's as if my attempts to escape merely loop back into endless dreams, leaving me trapped in a paradoxical cycle. I reflect on this intricate matrix of dreams that both guides and imprisons our lives.

There was a time, undoubtedly, when I wasn't so entwined in this dream-like existence. The possibility of me being the same person I am now would have been drastically altered, perhaps even extinguished. In that alternate reality, a different version of me would have been present, maybe not as accomplished as my current self, but almost certainly happier.

The thought tickles my imagination—another version of myself, possibly leading a life filled with more contentment.

It's clear that discussing my potential contentment wouldn't resonate with the world around me, a world where material wealth often takes centre stage in the pursuit of happiness. In the realm of mortals, the all-mighty dollar seems to hold dominion, and the relentless quest for it is often equated with a journey toward a divine purpose. It's as though, in the hierarchy of priorities, the

pursuit of wealth resides just slightly above the sacred.

Interestingly, despite my accumulated wisdom, I didn't choose the path of renunciation, opting to embrace a life of simplicity like a monk might. No, instead, I accumulated riches and possessions, chasing after what the world deemed valuable. Yet, the irony couldn't be starker—I find myself still grappling with dissatisfaction. Amidst the luxurious possessions, the overflowing wealth, there remains an emptiness that defies explanation.

While I hesitate to label the almighty dollar as useless, it undeniably serves as the catalyst for lives lived on the edge of exhilaration and the promise of adventure. It propels individuals out of their comfort zones, urging them to traverse uncharted territories in the pursuit of greater rewards. This dynamic sustains a portion of the corporate world, fueling the vitality of what we sometimes term “corporate rats.”

However, what I yearn for isn't just the dismissal of the dollar's significance. Instead, I crave the return to a life of raw adventure, reminiscent of a place where currency held no power and skill was the compass guiding our endeavors. Those were the moments when life wasn't constrained by material wealth but was measured by the mastery of our abilities. And yet, even amidst such unfettered existence, I came to a resounding realization — I would never satiate my desires. My thirst for more, my craving to excel, seemed insatiable, perhaps a manifestation of the sin of wrath that lingered within me.

Not envy, not gluttony, but wrath — a unique kind that didn't breed hatred for others' achievements, but a seething resentment towards my own inadequacies. This

relentless thirst for power, an unquenchable desire, stood like an impenetrable barrier between me and true happiness.

As I typed away, I found myself seated in the luxurious confines of my beloved Cadillac Limousine. This very vehicle, often dubbed by the media as the “haven of opulence amidst the chaos of the outside world,” had witnessed numerous encounters with powerful figures. Yet, on this particular day, it was an unremarkable backdrop as I embarked on a sombre journey to attend a funeral.

The destination held memories that clashed with the extravagant nature of the car. Today was not a day to reminisce about opulence, but to commemorate a cherished friend. He had never seen me merely as a wealthy acquaintance; instead, he valued my wisdom. It wasn't my riches that mattered to him, but the depth of understanding that came with them. Ironically, his values were far removed from the materialistic pursuits that often consumed me.

And now, here I was, grappling with the devastating reality that he had taken his own life. A heinous act that left me stunned and bewildered. I questioned why he hadn't turned to me, his wealth-flaunting friend, for anything he desired. But it was evident that his struggles were beyond mere desires; they delved into the realm of love, a force I had never been adept at comprehending, let alone reasoning with. For even I had my encounters with it, and they were never pleasant.

Regret gnawed at me, a heavy burden to bear. In a world where my presence held the sway to procure anything, my absence at the time he needed me the most

left a gaping wound. As I continued to drive, the weight of this regret only grew heavier.

As I arrived at the funeral site, a surge of anger ignited within me. The scene before me seemed to fuel the fire within my veins. My dear friend lay in a casket crafted from the purest oak, a vessel for his departed soul. However, as I drew closer, paying no heed to the somber crowd that had gathered, my heart sank even further. The expression on his lifeless face revealed a truth that cut to the core—he hadn't known happiness in his lifetime. It was as if he had been so convinced that joy was beyond his reach that he had chosen the path that led us to this mournful gathering.

Pushing aside the throng of onlookers, I focused solely on him. His face told a story of unspoken pain, of a life that had been devoid of the happiness he so deserved. It was a heart-wrenching realization that he had felt so certain of his perpetual sorrow that he had chosen this tragic end.

As I paid my final respects to my fallen friend, my grief overwhelmed me. Unable to hold back the torrent of emotions, I found myself sobbing uncontrollably over his oakwood coffin. In my life, I had weathered the storms of people's cruelty, never letting it affect me. But Jerry, my dear friend, had borne the weight of such torment. He should have spoken up, he should have reached out, for I would have moved mountains to ease his suffering. I would have unleashed assassins or even taken lives myself if he so wished. Why had he remained silent? What had given him the right to endure his struggles in solitude?

Anguish gripped my heart as I lamented the promise

we had once made—to share each other's burdens. How dare he leave this world before me? The weight of his absence was crushing, and my tears fell onto the coffin as a testament to the depth of my sorrow.

As I stepped away from the center stage, allowing the focus to rightfully shift to my departed friend, I caught sight of a face that ignited a blaze of anger within me. It was the very same face that had held Jerry's heart, the reason for his untimely journey into eternity. It was 'her'—the girl Jerry had adored, the one whose presence had prompted his fateful path to heaven. And the only person in this whole wide world that should have avoided this ceremony. My instinct was to rush forward, fueled by a surge of rage, and deliver a punch with all the force I could muster. But as she turned to face me, my hand froze mid-air.

Confronted by her tear-streaked face, my anger faltered. She wasn't here merely to look at the part; her tears were genuine. The girl, who had been the cause of so much turmoil, stood before me, her sorrow evident. It was the same sorrow I had felt when my wrath took control. "I thought you never loved him, so why are you crying here? Just a ploy to gain my sympathy, you hag," I challenged, my words laced with bitterness. I felt a verbal duel was the least she deserved, given her role as the catalyst.

However, as her voice met my ears, my resolve wavered. Her response held a mix of guilt and sadness, a tone that I recognized all too well. It was the voice I had often used—riddled with remorse and longing. "Charlie, you of all people know why I couldn't be with Jerry. And no, I'm not seeking favors from you by shedding tears.

Despite not being his girlfriend, I was his close friend. He was there for me in times of need, even when I couldn't pinpoint the source of my sadness. He offered unwavering support, even when I was unable to articulate my struggles. So, you don't have the right to tarnish my last memory of him just because you couldn't control your wrath," she spoke, her words carrying the weight of both guilt and sorrow.

Stunned by her response, my hand fell to my side, and I retreated, unable to muster a response. Instead, I retreated from the situation, my thoughts in turmoil. I moved through the crowd, keeping my words unspoken, until I reached Jerry's grieving parents. There, I engaged in conversation, offering whatever support I could provide. I made it my mission to ensure that Jerry's siblings would find happiness, a lasting tribute to his memory.

The funeral unfolded against a backdrop of sadness and contemplation. Emotions ran deep, the weight of our loss hanging in the air, tugging at the heartstrings of all present. The sight of Jerry's lifeless form in the casket was a painful reminder of the fragility of life. Each tear shed was a testament to the bonds we shared, the unspoken words and the moments forever lost to time.

As I managed to slip away during the prayers, a man in a sleek black suit crossed my path. His demeanour suggested authority, as if he were about to read a will. Just as I moved to distance myself, he stepped closer, his presence impossible to ignore. "Sir," he began, his tone both formal and urgent, "you have been summoned by the Observationis Fundamenta and If I may be so bold, I implore you to lower your magical pressure, lest this

sacred church crumble under its power.”

A mysterious voice echoed the man's warning, emphasizing the gravity of the situation. “Peregrino Observationis Fundamenta wants me now?” I inquired, a mix of curiosity and exasperation lacing my words. The timing felt inappropriate for political games or the introduction of new policies. All I yearned for was to be left in peace, to reflect on my dear friend Jerry and to ensure that no one else suffered as he had. But the voice's presence vanished as quickly as it had appeared. It dawned on me that the world government's concern for Jerry's well-being had likely been non-existent. This was no moment to ignite a rebellion against the world; it was a time to grieve.

Reluctantly, I surrendered to the embrace of my waiting Cadillac, instructing the driver to head for the nearest stronghold. The leather seats cocooned me in a sense of isolation as the vehicle glided forward. The outside world blurred by a backdrop to my sombre thoughts. My heart ached for the friend I had lost and for the journey that lay ahead.

20. Resonance Of Fear

“Bit of a cloudy day, isn’t it?” I ventured, injecting a touch of conversation into the heavy silence that draped around us like a wet blanket. The sky above was a tapestry of Gray, a reflection of the mood that enveloped me.

“Indeed, sir,” the driver replied in that impeccably British way of his. His voice held the essence of a refined gentleman, a perfect complement to the sophisticated chaos of the city.

“But if I’m not mistaken, the stronghold should be just a stone’s throw away, shouldn’t it?” I pressed on, a feeble attempt to engage in dialogue that might distract me from my thoughts.

“Absolutely spot-on, sir,” he confirmed, his response laced with an air of empathy. He seemed to understand the weight of my emotions, the heaviness that came with the loss of a friend. His willingness to engage in the conversation was a soothing balm for my troubled mind.

Yet, the notion of comfort eluded me. The blame for my friend’s tragic end rested squarely on my shoulders, a reality I couldn’t escape. The tendrils of karma wound around my existence, weaving a complex tapestry of challenges and hardships for both me and those around me. Every twist and turn seemed to lead to another challenge, creating an endless loop of trials that refused to relent. In the midst of this journey to the stronghold, I realized that I still had my diary to maintain. And so, within the quiet confines of the backseat, I began to pen down my thoughts, finding a semblance of solace amid

the turmoil.

"Sir, if I may venture a question, why might the government be summoning you at such a delicate juncture?" The driver's voice cut through the silence, his words carrying a gentle sympathy as he deftly maneuvered through the congested traffic.

Ah, the government—the orchestrator of policies and power plays. "Well," I began with a blend of cynicism and weariness, "the government, you see, has a peculiar affinity for ideologies and securing voter loyalty. Individuals hardly register on their radar. Swap those voters for voting birds, and I doubt they'd lose sleep. They've beckoned me because they require something from me, something so crucial that even the media's glare won't dissuade them. I'm half-expecting they'll ask for more charitable contributions. Not that I'm averse to giving, mind you, but when you've already doled out a hefty 4.5 billion, even the greediest among them should be appeased." My words held a tinge of frustration, a tangle of emotions that I allowed to unravel. There was no chance the driver would offer a contrary opinion; his loyalty lay steadfast.

"Absolutely, sir. It's quite the education, gaining insights into these matters while in your esteemed company," the driver responded, his gaze firmly fixed on the road ahead, his British smile as unwavering as his focus.

"Ah, you, hailing from the land of Her Majesty, wouldn't be steeped in such political nuances," I sighed, feeling the weight of years press upon me.

"Here we are, sir," the driver's voice pulled me from my thoughts as we pulled up in front of a modest five-

story building. Its unassuming facade was far from what one might expect of a government establishment, but then again, this building didn't belong to any one government. It was more accurate to say that every government belonged to the enigmatic group that owned this unmarked structure.

I stepped out of the Cadillac, my gaze sweeping over the building's exterior. "Tinted bulletproof glass and titanium alloy doors," the driver announced, his voice carrying a note of amusement, "Looks like they're our clientele." He held the door open for me, and I couldn't help but smile at his assessment. He had a knack for spotting the finer details that often went unnoticed.

As I approached the building, a fleeting sense of unease brushed against me, like a premonition of impending trouble. It was a sensation people described before the onset of something ominous, a momentary shiver that defied explanation. Pushing aside the unfounded apprehension, I continued forward. The bulletproof titanium alloy doors loomed ahead, and with them stood the same individual I had encountered at the church.

"Ah, we meet again," the man greeted, his Irish accent dancing in the air. He exuded confidence, knowing well that he held the reins within this building's walls.

"Well, obviously you invited me," I replied, my smile carrying a hint of playful arrogance. I was well aware of his role in this enigmatic establishment. He wouldn't dare to step before me unless he was certain of his position. After all, he was privy to the truth that remained hidden from the public eye.

"As you can imagine, sir, we should make our way to

the underground meeting area. Terminal #0045 will be waiting for us," he informed me, a clear path laid out for our next steps. His words were punctuated with a touch of formality as he gestured for me to follow.

I fell in step behind him, my anticipation growing with each stride. This was my inaugural visit to the oldest of the strongholds, a place shrouded in both mystery and significance. "It used to be a hospital," I remarked with a smile, memories of the past flooding my thoughts. This hospital held a special place in my history, but my companion seemed preoccupied, his attention fixed on matters that prevented him from responding to my remark.

We entered the building, greeted by an automated door that swung open, revealing a passage leading to a circular staircase. As we descended, my impatience began to tug at my composure. The atmosphere was charged with a sense of urgency, and I found myself succumbing to the impatience of my teenage years. It was a trait I had never been able to fully shake off, despite my accumulated years. My reservoir of patience had always been rather shallow, and this moment was no exception.

My patience dwindled further as the ascent continued, and the inevitable question slipped from my lips, "Well, are we there yet?" I couldn't help but indulge in the impatience of my teen self. Waiting had never been my strong suit. The question lingered, unanswered, in the air. However, before I could voice my query again, my impatience reached its limit. With a sudden decision, I seized the handrail and took a leap of faith.

As I somersaulted downwards, my mind raced, simultaneously calculating the number of floors I was

descending. The count was astonishing—each floor seemed to stretch on forever. The plummet seemed to last an eternity, roughly ten seconds of sheer free fall. My mental calculation indicated that the underground expanse was approximately 490 meters beneath the surface. Just before impact, I deftly reoriented my body, landing gracefully on my feet.

“Quite a basement you’ve got here,” I quipped, addressing the incredible depth of this stronghold. The Irish companion, too, landed with finesse, a testament to his own skills.

Our dialogue took an intriguing turn. “So, you’re also one of us?” I inquired, my curiosity piqued. It seemed that this man, with his Irish charm and enigmatic demeanor, was not just an ordinary acquaintance.

He nodded, his gaze steady. “Yes, sire. I am one of the Outriders,” he admitted, revealing his affiliation with the group.

His actions led us to a door that resembled a vault, designed to withstand substantial force—perhaps even a punch from me, though one strike would likely be its limit. The door’s resilience served as a reminder of the security that lay beyond. As it swung open, I stepped into a room dominated by a seemingly ordinary computer.

My frustration was evident as the words escaped my lips, a mixture of disbelief and exasperation. “So, I navigated through the traffic for this?” In most strongholds, the computer systems were nothing short of fantasy—state-of-the-art machines with specifications that would make any avid gamer weep tears of joy. But the computer before me shattered those expectations. Its appearance was antiquated, reminiscent of technology

from eras long past. Even my old MacBook could likely outpace it, and the LCD display seemed poised to inflict ocular distress.

“So, this is Terminal #0045?” I sighed, a sense of anticlimax washing over me. The incongruity of the situation wasn’t lost on me—a grand entrance to a room that contained a relic

“Well, it gets the job done,” the Irish man remarked, his understanding of my concerns evident. Taking a seat on the small chair he had pulled from a corner, I immediately connected to the server. Time was of the essence, especially before this antiquated display. As I accessed the server, a white blank screen greeted me, void of any content.

“Enter password,” an automated voice echoed through the old speakers.

‘Is God willing to prevent evil, but not able? Then he is not omnipotent.

Is he able, but not willing? Then he is malevolent.

Is he both able and willing? Then why does evil exist?

Is he neither able nor willing? Then why call him God?’

I typed the thought, aware that the god I was familiar with bore little resemblance to benevolence. With the password entered, I accessed what could be likened to a typical web meeting.

“It seems that the Pest Manager has graced us with his presence,” a familiar voice spoke—the head of the foundation known as ‘POF.’

“Well, I had my reasons to be late, and I am no Pest Manager. Please refer to me by my code name ‘Enuma,’ or better yet, don’t refer to me at all,” I retorted, my tone

aligning with his request.

“Ah, I, for one, believe that wasting our time talking to you is unnecessary,” the chairman chimed in.

“Then who will provide you with funding?” I taunted, a smirk tugging at my lips.

“Enough bickering, you two,” a voice laced with beauty intervened. “Chairman, don’t let him get under your skin. Enuma, relax,” Šanā’s voice resonated, a calming presence amidst the banter.

“Well, if you say so, Šanā,” I conceded, recognizing that even my considerable capabilities paled in comparison to Šanā’s unparalleled intellect and rhetoric.

“As you all are well aware, POF doesn’t convene meetings of this magnitude unless the matter at hand is of utmost importance,” Trítos’s unyielding voice spoke, her dedication to logic as unwavering as ever.

“Pentarchy must act, or else...” the chairman’s voice trailed off, hanging in the air with an ominous weight.

“Or else what, old man?” interjected Erbe’s ever-energetic voice. Despite the gravity of the situation, the familiarity of this group gathering brought a sense of comfort. Amidst the uncertainty, there was solace in knowing that a united front stood to protect the things I held dear.

“Sixth Calamity Class has been detected to be reincarnated and could potentially return to our world very soon,” the chairman’s words landed like a bombshell, shattering the conversation’s casual facade. The room fell silent, each person present grappling with the implications of what had just been revealed.

“Wait, so you’ve brought us together just because a sixth outrider might be joining the Pentarchy? Should we

start calling it the Hexarchy now?" I quipped, attempting to inject some semblance of humor into the increasingly dire situation unfolding before us.

"Our mana detectors have undergone a recent upgrade, allowing them to measure not only the quantity but also the quality of mana," the chairman explained in a deliberate and measured tone.

"I played my part in creating those machines, and Enuma provided the concept," Sana added with a sense of accomplishment.

"The readings indicate a mana source with the quantity of a soldier-level threat but the quality of a calamity class," the chairman continued, his words hanging in the air like a heavy shroud. "It's even more intense than what our sensors detected from the First Hero."

"If this newly reincarnated individual possesses mana more powerful than the First Hero, it means they have the potential to annihilate universes," Trítos's voice cut through the tense silence, amplifying the gravity of the situation.

"And that's precisely why we're all here," Défteros's voice joined the discussion, a voice I hadn't heard in some time.

"Indeed," the chairman affirmed.

"Can we infer from this discussion that the newcomer has a more potent divine heritage than the First Hero?" Sana's voice carried a note of contemplation.

"I'm afraid we have no choice but to reach that conclusion," Trítos responded, her tone resolute.

"Could we not simply eliminate the comatose body of the impending threat?" Défteros suggested, his words tinged with urgency.

“It’s not just a partial reincarnation—it’s a full-body rebirth,” the chairman explained, the weight of his words sinking in.

“This is worse than bad,” Erbe’s voice trembled, her concern palpable.

“I have a proposal,” Sana’s voice cut through the growing unease, capturing everyone’s attention.

“And what might that be?” I inquired, curiosity piqued.

“She’s thinking exactly what I’m thinking,” the chairman interjected, a hint of anticipation in his tone.

“If everyone agrees, that is,” Sana added, her voice holding a glimmer of hope.

And, almost in unison, the word “yes” echoed throughout the room, a chorus of agreement that resonated with urgency.

Then, the chairman’s voice took command, a crescendo of authority that sent shivers down my spine, ““Enuma—the mightiest of Pentarchy, the cosmic obliterator, the embodiment of infinite devastation. We, the Pentarchy, implore you not only to step forth but to utterly annihilate the emerging hero of the First World. You are allowed to use 100% of your powers”.

21. Unveiling Dominion

(Jerry POV)

The Witch of Annihilation didn't appear to be interested in my recent victory, as she refrained from praising me. We swiftly navigated our way out of the makeshift battlefield, veering towards the outer path of the city, now stained with the blood of the fallen. The witch, however, didn't spare a glance for them, almost as if she had long been accustomed to the presence of death, far preceding my own experiences. Witnessing so many lifeless bodies was a new and unsettling experience for me. In my world, it wasn't an everyday occurrence to engage in battles against dozens of adversaries single-handedly in order to rectify a mistake. Usually, to make amends for my errors, a simple apology sufficed.

"Do not misunderstand, brave hero of the elves. Vampires like us are not weakened by the sight of blood; rather, the spectacle of battle invigorates us," Liza said suddenly, her steps coming to a halt as she positioned herself in a corner beneath the watchtower's shadow. "I'm not seeking rewards. I'm simply intrigued by what sets you apart from the crowd that gathers to celebrate this victory," I inquired, my attempt to impress her still bearing no fruits. "Part of the reason is your utilization of mana, and partly it's what you accomplished with your mana," responded the witch. Her demeanour had shifted from its usual flirtatious nature to a more serious one, making her harder to read.

"By my utilization of mana, do you mean the way I

conjured fire or electricity?” I inquired; a clear sense of confusion etched on my face. After all, it was Liza who had encouraged me to integrate the basics of chemistry and physics into the world of magic. As I brainstormed this, Liza’s form began to radiate a familiar ethereal glow—those intricate shapes that manifested around her when she manipulated her magic. Witnessing this phenomenon, even though it had occurred multiple times before, continued to evoke a sense of wonder. But that was the nature of this world.

“I hope you can perceive these shapes surrounding me,” Liza stated, her gaze fixed on me.

“Yes, I do,” I responded softly.

“These shapes are a manifestation of my mana, constantly analysing the elements present around me. When activated, they simplify the process of performing magic, and it took me several centuries to refine them,” Liza explained, her voice tinged with both frustration and jealousy.

“I’m still not finding the point,” I admitted, feeling somewhat foolish.

“You can instantaneously analyse billions upon billions of moles of atoms around you and then direct your mana to encompass them, manipulating the mana in such a way that it influences the atoms as intended,” irritation flashed in her eyes, and she seemed on the brink of resorting to the methods favoured by the hounds.

“Well, it’s not quite like that for me. I simply command my mana to create a potential difference, and it takes care of the rest autonomously. Or I can just ask it to conjure up hydrogen, and it obliges. Isn’t that what you mentioned when you taught me the basics of chemistry? I

merely instruct my mana," I explained, a growing sense of inadequacy gnawing at me.

"The term 'basic' was sarcasm," the Witch of Annihilation exclaimed exasperatedly. "In this world, only a few individuals possess the ability to affect the physics around them. Most people channel their mana within themselves and convert it into energy tailored for specific tasks. What you can do is essentially reshape the bonds and properties of matter surrounding you. It's as if you have dominion over it, and here's the crucial point: mana of others doesn't usually respond to commands like yours. You're the sole individual in this world with that capability."

"Wait, what?" I exclaimed, utterly shocked by her revelation.

"Yes, mana doesn't respond the way you used it today. Merely stating a command rarely achieves anything here. Almost everyone in this world, except for a select few, has to learn countless spells to accomplish what you did," Liza explained.

"Are spells not just instructions given in a different language?" I asked, my curiosity piqued.

"Spells essentially create pathways for mana to follow. They guide the flow of mana and instruct it on what actions to take. Your method, though, involves direct commands without providing any guidance on where or how to apply force. For instance, you said you needed hydrogen, and it manifested. That difference in power is tremendous," Liza explained, her underlying jealousy evident. It made sense; after all, she was a witch, and from my childhood lessons, I knew that witches often had a short temper.

“But how is that even possible?” I inquired, making sure to convey a sympathetic tone to Liza.

“Well, whatever. It’s not as if that changes anything,” Liza retorted, her irritation palpable.

“I suppose it must be challenging not to have the power to manipulate physics through simple commands,” I commented with a hint of audacity.

“Firstly, I am among the rare few who can reshape the world around themselves. Secondly, the command power you possess—I’ve created the ‘Flash Enchanting’ technique, ensuring we’re evenly matched in terms of speed. And don’t you dare think that I would ever lose to someone like you,” Liza asserted, her anger radiating in a way that discouraged any further audacity from me.

“Well, considering you’re THE Witch of Annihilation,” I remarked, layering my words with flattery.

“Do you even comprehend what it truly means to be The Witch of Annihilation?” Liza taunted, her tone cutting. “No, but I’m eager to learn,” I quickly interjected, hoping to delve deeper into the concept of titles.

“Before we go into that, I need to address the second matter. First, the stunt you pulled in broad daylight, but that is beside the point, the second act of yours is so severe that if the Holy Empire were to find out about it, I doubt they’d spare your life,” Liza stated, suddenly recalling her intention to discuss two topics.

“Well, what is it, madam?” I inquired politely, fully aware that I had already managed to stir the emotions of one of the most formidable individuals around—an action that generally leads to unfavourable outcomes.

“The fact that you raised Death with your commands

means you hold dominion over them, or at least a certain control over death,” Liza said, her gaze fixed on me with seriousness. This makes you desirable to many wealthy individuals, particularly the Grand Duke who is aging and would undoubtedly appreciate meeting someone with the power to manipulate death,” the witch explained.

“Are you trying to win him over” said a friendly voice.

22. Convergence

As I turned around, a smile graced my face. Standing before me was Elfona, the matriarch of the elves and the one person who didn't radiate a dark aura. She approached me, her hand resting gently on my shoulder, her eyes filled with pride.

"Lord Hero, is she threatening you?" Elfona inquired, her concern evident in her voice.

"No," I replied, choosing not to escalate any potential conflict between the trio. I was well aware of the complexities of their relationships.

Elfona's next question, however, cut straight to the heart of the matter. "She purposely didn't teach you any spells, did she?" Elfona asked, pulling me closer to her side with a gentle yet firm grasp.

"Yeah, so what if I did?" Liza retorted defiantly. In that moment, a subtle but ominous shift occurred. Everything around Liza took on a distinct tint of purple, and my instincts screamed at me to take cover.

Elfona's response was calm but unwavering. "It's criminal," she declared. Even as we stood on a stone road, I watched as small plants around us sprang to life, their roots and stems creeping toward me with an eerie determination.

Suddenly, with a speed that defied comprehension, Elfona lunged at Liza, and they both vanished from my sight. I stood there, frozen, my mind racing with worry about what might transpire next. Then, in an instant, the creeping roots that had been inching toward me changed

their course. They swiftly encased me in a protective cocoon-like structure.

Before I could even catch my breath, I heard a tremendous explosion. The voices around me grew hushed, and my cocoon of writhing plant life withered away. As I peered outside, the sun dipped below the horizon, casting an eerie evening glow over the scene. Before me stood a defeated-looking Liza and a stern-faced Elfona. To my surprise, they weren't fighting anymore.

However, an overwhelming presence filled the air, sending shivers down my spine. It was a premonition of something truly terrifying. While my instincts usually urged me to hide from Liza, the Witch of Annihilation, this new sensation rendered me utterly helpless. It compelled me to accept my fate, to surrender to the impending doom.

That's when I saw her – Hecate. She loomed in the background, radiating an impenetrable black aura that seemed to seep into the environment. It drained the surroundings of their color, rendering everything in its path a lifeless black. Above her head, a golden title hovered like an angelic halo, but it bore an ominous message: Night's Sovereign.

"Lord Hero, do you hold any grudge against Liza?" Hecate asked in a rather casual tone. As I turned to look at Liza, her eyes pleaded for my support.

"No, I don't. Liza didn't do anything worth fighting over. She simply shared what she could in the limited time we had," I replied, recognizing the urgency of preventing this confrontation from escalating. A serious clash between these powerful beings could spell disaster for the

entire planet.

“I’m surprised you didn’t cause any property damage,” Hecate remarked, her laughter suggesting that such events were a normal occurrence.

“Well, Liza did cast a time-stop spell on the property, freezing everything in its original state until her mana runs out,” Elfona explained, her voice strangely calm amidst the chaos.

“Yeah, I’m that good,” Liza chimed in with her usual flirty tone.

“So, you guys are just friends again?” I asked, bewildered by the sudden shift from a heated battle to apparent camaraderie.

“This does feel a bit disorienting,” Hecate admitted with a smile directed at Elfona.

“What?” I inquired, sensing that I might be the target of an inside joke.

“Well, the difference in personalities between you and Lord First,” Liza explained. “While you’re still pondering over why the fight happened and all, he would be here, laughing with us. He really knew when to think and when to just enjoy the moment.”

“I’ve heard a lot about Mister Lord First, but no one ever told me about his powers,” I remarked, recognizing the sensitivity of the topic.

The mood grew somber, and silence hung in the air. Even the stone-paved road seemed to lose its vitality.

“His ability was destruction, and his patron was called the Chain Archangel, the Left Arm of God,” Elfona finally broke the silence, her voice barely audible.

“Yes, I know that. The hound I fought told me. But why is he revered almost as much as a god?” I asked

cautiously, treading carefully to avoid offending their beliefs.

“He was summoned for the first time to defeat the Titans, primordial consciousnesses created by gods who absorbed mana and the elements of nature. Leading them was the Titan of Space-Time, believed to have direct control over time and space. Somehow, Lord First confronted and defeated him in his own palace on the second day of his existence in this world. On his third and final day of the first trip, he liberated the elves from the chambers of the Titans, where they were nothing more than toys. He set the elves free to exist in harmony with nature, for better or worse,” Liza explained.

“So, he’s the reason the Elven Kingdom started,” I noted.

“He was summoned again by the fourth Hero in a campaign to vanquish lesser gods – beings who had absorbed the remnants of Titans and had the power to overpower even hundreds of vampires. It was during this journey that he realized the true nature of God, the entity experimenting with elements in this universe like it’s a playground. He promptly established this kingdom and utilized his power to create Titles, preventing God from toying with lives. Though when he helped liberate Vampire nobility from lesser gods and helped them and elves come together and set up this nation he was called biased by humans and dubbed ‘The Wicked One’ by the Holy Kingdom, he cared little for his image. He was truly the ultimate Hero,” Hecate explained, her voice filled with reverence and tears glistening in her eyes.

“And he was my husband,” she added, her voice barely audible, as if meant for my ears alone.

“At the end of his last journey, he was bestowed with the title of the strongest in the universe. So, I hope you’ll continue his legacy. After all, you come from the same native place,” Liza said, trying to lighten the atmosphere with her playful tone, despite the weight of the moment. “I have the ability to summon two Hero Aids from my world. Maybe we can use one to summon Lord First?” I suggested. However, my proposal seemed to have left everyone momentarily stunned, as if a flashbang had gone off in their minds, rendering them momentarily speechless.

Before long, a voice cut through the perplexed silence. “So, what’s going on here?”

23. Resurrection Of

From the shadows emerged Lord Koss, exuding his vampiric allure. "Ah, it seems my keen ears were correct about the summoning of our Lord," he remarked, offering a playful wink as he materialized before me. He positioned himself squarely in front of the trio. "However," he began, "the logistics involved in this endeavour will be nothing short of mind-boggling. The impending war will rage from three sides until Our Benevolent Majesty can manifest in this world. His very mana will inevitably breach the limitations imposed by the three-nation pact. I am confident that victory shall be ours once His Majesty graces us with his presence. But, let us not underestimate the damage the Holy Kingdom might inflict in the meantime."

Liza's voice resonated with newfound hope as she interjected, "Nevertheless, there remains a chance to bring my teacher back, and I am willing to seize it."

Elfona, seemingly taking a calculated risk, chimed in with a measured tone, "The details of logistics can be addressed later. I don't believe the Holy Empire will launch their attack with such swiftness."

"Well, Koss, if you have such a vivid grasp of world politics, then go and prepare all the borders for war and alert all the left vampires that 'we must prepare for an all-out battle because this world is not letting us resummon our lord,'" Hecate exclaimed with an excited tone. Her voice was filled with anticipation as she continued, "This will certainly ignite their spirits."

“As you say, ma’am,” Lord Koss responded obediently. With that, he transformed into a swirling vortex of darkness and disappeared.

Liza then took charge, declaring, “Then we must make our way to the temple.” She began to levitate, but Hecate playfully teased her, “Hold on, our little hero can’t fly, so let’s at least escort him a little so that he can walk there.” She pointed towards a gate in the wall, and we all walked towards it. I couldn’t help but wonder if we had enough time before dawn.

Before I could voice my thoughts, Hecate addressed them, saying, “No, we vampires don’t melt in the sun, and what strange ideas you have about us, you weirdo.” She continued with a smirk, “I can read your mind, you dumbo.”

Elfona, who had been the most welcoming and kind-hearted of the trio, chimed in, “Well, let’s climb up these ladders, Lord Hero, and then we’ll get to see the beautiful temple.” Her smile was genuine, and it was clear that she held me in high regard, just as my title suggested.

As we ascended those ladders, I gazed upon the vast desert stretching across the land, creating a stark contrast to the city nestled like an oasis amidst the arid expanse. “We are surrounded by a rainforest, plains, and even a desert; this location is unique in that regard,” remarked Liza, as if she were effortlessly reading my thoughts, akin to a child’s play.

Curiosity tugging at my mind, I inquired, “But how did this come to be? It seems so unnatural.”

“Well,” Elfona began, her tone tinged with an unusual sadness, “Lord Hero actually created this desert while battling the Prince of All Titans. This desert is brimming

with time anomalies due to that epic clash. The temple we're headed to is where his head landed, which is why this desert is saturated with mana. However, all the unnatural wonders you admire right now, they're not benign; they're detrimental to the actual biosphere."

Understanding washed over me, and I nodded. "I see." My gaze remained fixed on the desert, searching for any signs of peculiarity.

With a swift departure, Liza and Hecate ascended into the air, vanishing in a burst of sound. Elfona's demeanour seemed to shift; her voice grew bolder, and her countenance transformed. Her once soft opal face now bore a scowl of anger. "Well, unlike those vampires, we Elves prioritize style and comfort."

"Let's proceed then," Elfona declared, leaping from the wall. "Follow me, Lord Hero," she beckoned from below. I hesitated, nerves bubbling within, but my trust in Elfona, perhaps due to her kind nature or her profound respect for me, urged me forward. With closed eyes, I took a deep breath and made the leap.

As I opened my eyes, I found myself cradled in a soft embrace, nestled on Elfona's thigh. Her words carried a sense of urgency, "Lord Hero, you must grow stronger, especially with the return of the FIRST hero." As she rose, it became apparent that we weren't moving conventionally; rather, it felt like the world around us was in motion. Elfona was manipulating space, guiding us as if we were riding a cosmic wave. "If you're wondering about our mode of transportation, I'm simply navigating us through space, like we're some kind of wave," she explained with sincerity. "Don't inquire about the specifics; Liza is more knowledgeable in that area. I

apologize for her behaviours; her species tends to drain her kindness.”

As we approached the temple, it stood as a testament to a bygone era. This temple, constructed after the demise of the Prince of All Titans, was a haunting marvel. It was crafted from dark, weathered stone, reminiscent of ancient Gothic architecture. The structure was surrounded by a serene pond, mirroring the temple’s imposing presence. The temple’s design bore a striking resemblance to the architectural grandeur of an old mosque, with intricately carved arches and towering minaret-like spires.

“Behold the temple of destruction etched upon the mana-filled area where the Titan of Time’s head landed. This will be where our Lord will return,” announced Hecate, her voice resonating with a sense of solemnity as she approached me. “I will protect you with my life, while Liza will protect the universe from destruction, and Elfona will safeguard the area from collapsing,” she declared, joined by Liza, whose request for action carried a rare note of genuineness.

With a sense of purpose, I turned my back to the temple, determined not to harm its sacred structure. “Start the summoning!” I shouted, echoing my previous experience. My vision glitched, and I found myself back in my system viewer, my access window to the Index of Magic. My health was fully restored, and my mana reserves were replenished, although they fluctuated strangely, possibly due to my unique title, ‘Judgment of God,’ continuously filling them. I focused harder, recalling everything I knew about the First Hero.

Slowly, a blue vortex materialized before me, but

instead of sucking in the air, it expelled it outward, as if it were meant to expel something rather than draw it in. the summoning had began.

24. Revelation

(Charlie POV)

“This pentarchy gives me a headache, really,” I complained, though I knew it was a futile protest. The decision had been made collectively by the pentarchy, and opposing them would mean exposing my privacy and potentially risking a battle against all five of them and their respective armies from every nation.

“Well, it can’t be helped, sir. The Sixth Calamity Class is a major obstacle when it comes to decision-making. The efficiency of the pentarchy hinges on their unique personalities,” the Irishman said, attempting to console me.

“You do realize I’m not opposing them simply for the sake of it. It’s been ages since I’ve put my powers to the test,” I said, walking through the metallic vault and stretching. “Well, it’s been a while since I took a leap,” I added, pushing off and effortlessly reaching the top of the spiral staircase. Upon landing, I heard another thud.

“You know, the staircase is rather useless,” I chuckled.

“Well, we do need to send some cleaning staff down there as well,” the Irishman replied.

As I exited the ‘P.O.F’ building, my British driver stood by the gate, ready to open my car. Everything was as usual, and we drove in silence. However, the silence was suddenly broken as the car came to a halt.

“Who dares stop me?” I questioned, stepping out of the vehicle. To my surprise, the person before me was none other than the father of my fallen friend, Jerry.

"Uncle, you shouldn't have. You could have just called me, and I would have come," I said, attempting to make amends for my earlier rudeness.

"Well, Charlie, there are a few things I've kept hidden from Jerry that need to be revealed," Jerry's father explained. "I am Défteros, the Fourth Hero of the First World, second only to The Great ENUMA," he continued, sending a shiver down my spine.

"Wait, that means..." I began to say, but he cut me off.

"Yes, the Sixth Calamity Class must be Jerry, because I used all the life force of the Angel of Creation to create a fate where my family would forever be happy," Défteros admitted, his voice filled with melancholy. "I was dubbed 'the greedy one' by God and ended up establishing a dictatorship," I added, my voice devoid of mercy as I remembered how his selfishness had caused suffering in my kingdom in the First World.

"But I attended his funeral. Don't reincarnated people go into a coma in our world?" I inquired.

"Well, there's always the second option of full-body reincarnation," Défteros explained. "So you faked a funeral for Public, but then you saw a P.O.F. member meeting me at the church. Quite lucky you got there, it seems. I must have left my chrono Destinatus off for too long."

I spoke, but Jerry's father quickly walked away. I, too, had little desire to continue the conversation, and I retreated to my car. "Step on it," I commanded the driver, and he accelerated. We soon arrived at my penthouse.

"Sir, your family seems to be waiting at the mansion," my driver informed me politely.

"Exactly why I chose this destination," I replied. I

quickly exited the car and entered the elevator, taking a few moments to collect my thoughts.

“Now, I need to concentrate,” I reminded myself as I settled into a yoga-like stance in the middle of my room. I muttered, “I hope this works quickly; I have a business meeting scheduled.” With that, I began the process of slowly dismantling the thick mana barrier outlining our universe. But before I could attune my frequency to the realm between universes, the realm of God, I was involuntarily pulled into it.

“This marks the third time,” a voice stated, but it sounded as though the speaker was conversing through a vacuum cleaner, the words oscillating and messy.

“Well, well, well, if it isn’t the chained Archangel of Destruction,” I remarked, observing a white man with wings as white as snow, standing in the middle of the white empty room, his hands clasped in prayer-like fashion.

“Not so chained, and not so Archangel of Destruction anymore, after you shouldered all the burden assigned to me,” the Archangel replied in a playfully passive-aggressive tone.

“I couldn’t help but pity you, being chained for billions of years,” I retorted mockingly.

“Well, this time will be the last time you see me because, as the rule dictates, I must grant you some part of my power, and you’ve taken nearly all the time when you freed me. So this time, I will give you my all,” the angel said, turning his gaze towards me. The red iris that I grown familiar to, now appeared filled with sadness.

“No, I won’t accept that. I already have enough of these abilities,” I replied with frustration. I had grown

tired of people sacrificing for me just to earn my gratitude.

"Let's examine your abilities as this will be for our last time. God's Left Hand, granting you Universal Destruction Authority, the power to control destruction on a universal scale. Cosmic Deicide, a misfit from the Rule of God, which allows you to eliminate all concept law and even the divine. And the Chrono-Destinatus. These powers you possess can surely annihilate anything unfortunate enough to cross your path. But Father's will is absolute alas I need to give you all my existence all my powers all my authority and My title," the angel explained his expression were neutral but his voice had a sense of urgency, before transforming into dark light and vanishing. Suddenly, everything became clear to me.

"So that's how it is," I muttered, finally understanding why my life had been so dramatic, and I was not pleased. "God, I know you're here. Show yourself," I demanded.

"Well, son, what do you require?" a voice resonated from within me, sending tremors through my chest.

"No, I'm not having that not showing yourself thing anymore. I want to face you," I demanded.

"Son, if I enter any realm with more presence than what I've allocated to you right now, that realm will collapse," the voice replied.

"You do realize that this also applies to me," I pointed out as I released my magic, unveiling the dominion of destruction. Everything began to collapse, and even the white surroundings tore apart, revealing darkness in its wake.

"Well, you've made quite a mess," a voice remarked from behind me, suddenly restoring the arena.

"You do realize that was a mere fraction of the powers

I have,” I retorted as I turned to face a white figure with no face and no body, just a white outline. “What did you want to say, son?” the voice grew sterner by the second.

“Well, you do know that you’re being controlled,” I said as a vortex opened in front of me.

“LEAVE!” the god shouted.

To be continued...

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Obviously talking in third Person is difficult for me
I am Teerth Sharma, Allen, 12th grader currently at 2023
and I enjoy many pursuit in life.

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